黎明依旧到来
Dawn Arrives as Usual

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水泥蝴蝶
Crushed Butterflies CH18601-01

???: ……你不该来这里。
???: You shouldn't be here.

???: 人类的军队就在附近。与他们正面对上不是一个好主意。
???: The humans are near. You won't be able to face them all.

???: 你快走吧，萨莫蒂瓦。
???: Leave while you still can, Samodiva.

萨莫蒂瓦?: 谁死了让你当老大了?
Samodiva?: *Last I checked, you were in no position to order me around.*

萨莫蒂瓦?: 我还没有沦落到需要一个叛徒来指挥我。记住，让我暂时放弃杀死你的，只是你“回归族群”的承诺。
Samodiva?: *No one tells me what to do, especially not you, traitor. Remember this: I only spare you now because of your promise to "return to our people."*

萨莫蒂瓦?: 不管你留着那个无鳞鬼的命，究竟是为了“永恒的灵魂”，还是别的什么……等下次，最好不要让我看到它还活着。否则——
Samodiva?: *As for that scaleless, whether you've kept it alive for their "eternal soul" or whatever else, it'd better be a corpse next time I see it.*

萨莫蒂瓦?: 我会替你了结。
Samodiva?: *Or I will do that work for you.*

???: ……

???: ...

维拉: ……

Vila: ...

维拉: 呃——

Vila: Uhh ...

维拉: ……哈……

Vila: *panting*

从梦中挣脱，她睁开双眼，瞧见的并非熟悉的铅灰色天幕，也不是低矮狭窄的木板房顶，而是一尘不染的白色天花板。
The dream fades. Vila opens her eyes, looking up at an unfamiliar ceiling.

维拉: 哦，天哪。我这是……
Vila: Where am I?

转头，目之所及也是风格冷硬的室内装饰。标志性的提醒，令她清楚地知晓自己现在所处位置并非小镇。
She sits up and looks around. The white and gray diamond patterns on the wall reminding her that this is not Rayashki.

维拉: ……呼。
Vila: *breathes out*

维拉: 原来还在基金会。
Vila: Still in the Foundation.

一阵悉窣的响动之后，她利落地从床铺上爬起来。即使入睡也保持着整洁与得体，这位客人随时准备着离开此地。
There isn't another second to be spent in bed. She is up with her clothes tidy and neat—ready to leave any minute, even in her sleep.

维拉：很好，新的一天。
Vila: Fine then. A brand-new day.

最后一步，从桌边拿起临时计划表。新的一天，要做的事情还有许多。
The last step in her routine, checking her schedule for what must be done.

基金会职员 I：……总部有消息……需要再抽调人手……
Foundation Staff I: Message from the HQ ... more manpower ...

基金会职员 I：名单……你过去么，维涅齐卡?
Foundation Staff I: List of names ... Are you going? Vinchik?

基金会职员 II：名单不是还没公布吗？不管怎么样，我都宁可呆在这儿。既不是外派调查员，也才入职这些时日……无论如何都轮不上我。
Foundation Staff II: It's not released yet. But I hope to stay here, to be honest. I've barely passed training. What use could I be?

基金会职员 I：可别这么说。现在这情况，谁知道呢……
Foundation Staff I: You never know in a situation like this.

另一头，轻快的脚步朝着正在交谈的两人靠近。
Vila's cheerful footsteps draw near to the chatting staff.

维拉：早上好，两位。我想请问——
Vila: Good morning, I'd like to ask ...

基金会职员 I：嗯？噢，你好，愿和平与我们同在。请问你需要些什么?
Foundation Staff I: Hmm? Oh, morning, Ms. Vila. May the peace be with us.

基金会职员 I：——维拉女士?
Foundation Staff I: How can we help you?

维拉：您好，塔季扬娜女士，维涅齐克特先生。
Vila: Ms. Tatyana, Mr. Vincent.

维拉：请问我之前申请的杂物室使用权，得到批复了吗?
Vila: I was wondering if my application for the utility room has been approved.

基金会职员 II：你申请了日间使用？如果是那间靠窗的杂物室，那么提交申请之后的七个工作日内会有答复。
Foundation Staff II: You were looking to use it during the daytime, yes? Well, you should receive a decision soon, within seven working days.

维拉：七个工作日？可这似乎是不对的，先生。
Vila: Seven days? That was not what I was told, sir.

维拉：按照我所知的流程，最晚今天得到批准，我就能带来亚什基的孩子们立刻过去。
Vila: They said it would be decided today at the latest, so that we might hold an art class there.

维拉：他们期待这堂美术课很久了。
Vila: The children have been looking forward to it.

维拉：申请中我也写明了使用起始日期，或许要麻烦你们再次确认一下。
Vila: Could you double-check my application? You can find the date I first submitted it here.

基金会职员 II： 最近分部的人力资源被占用了太多，现在处理这类申请的响应速度会比一般预期缓慢……

Foundation Staff II: Sorry, we're really tied up these days. The process might take more time than expected.

身穿白衣的女性用手肘拐了拐身边的人，把他的话打断了。
The female staff elbows the other and interrupts him.

基金会职员 II： 咳！总之，由于流程变动，你的申请确实还没有得到批复。

Foundation Staff II: Ahem! That isn't quite it. You see, there's been a change in procedure.

维拉： 那么，我能不能先使用那间杂物室？孩子们会帮忙收拾物什，不会占用更多人力。

Vila: Then might we just use the room, first? The kids will help clean, no need for any concern.

维拉： 我们也不会弄坏任何东西。

Vila: And we'll be careful with everything there.

基金会职员 II： 我明白你的意思，也理解这件事的迫切，女士。但这不符合规定。

Foundation Staff II: I understand, miss. But it's against the rules.

轻巧的脚步声突然在大理石地板上响起。迫近后，一个小东西飞快挤进似乎陷入僵持的三人之中。
A small figure wades into the scene, breaking the increasing tension of their confrontation.

就像企鹅会紧贴着彼此取暖，不请自来的孩子抬起头，以热切的目光紧紧“拥抱”着大人们。
He looks up at them with irrepressible eagerness and warmth.

或者说，至少“拥抱”着其中一个大人。
Or at least one of them.

???: 维拉，你好，你在这里！

???: Hello, Vila! I've found you!

基金会职员 II： ……？

Foundation Staff II: ...?

维拉： 我在这里。你也好，阿夫西维同志。

Vila: Yes, here I am. Hello to you too, Comrade Avgust.

维拉： 我瞧瞧……八点二十分，你很守时。但是你的朋友们呢？你们应该一起行动的。

Vila: Let me see ... 08:20, you're on time. But what about your friends? Why didn't you come together?

阿夫西维： 他们和命名日在一起！命名日又带来了会咬人的硬币，彼得森说他要再试一次，看看谁的牙齿更厉害——

Avgust: They're with Mr. Name Day! He brought us the biting coin again. Pyotr says he wants to have a contest with it. They will bite each other and see who has sharper teeth.

阿夫西维： 但那个硬币上的小猫同志在打瞌睡。我觉得，如果比赛是让他们互相咬一口，那彼得森肯定会赢。

Avgust: But the kitty on the coin is sleeping. We're waiting for it to wake up first.

阿夫西维： 所以，我知道比赛的结果，只要在“颁奖”开始之前回去就好了。

Avgust: I'm sure Pyotr will win, so I will not be watching the contest. I will just return for the rewards.

基金会职员 I： 这……

Foundation Staff I: A biting coin ...

基金会职员 II： 我就说小会议室那枚活泼利齿子儿是被命名日拿走了！他还对那玩意儿施了昏睡咒，怪不得它没法防止任何人在开会的时候打瞌睡——
Foundation Staff II: So, it was Name Day who took the sharpodonty from the meeting room! They wanted it to wake up anyone that fell asleep during that long meeting. But he must have used a slumber incantation to make it sleep instead!

基金会职员 II： 不行，我得找他拿回来。
Foundation Staff II: I'll have to get it back from him.

维拉： ……请原谅，我需要先带这个孩子去与命名日先生会合。
Vila: Let me help. I should take Avgust to find Mr. Name Day.

维拉： 我们会另找无需申请的空地上课，那枚利齿子儿我也会带来给您。
Vila: And in the meantime, we'll just have to find another place for our class, one without lengthy approvals. I'll bring the sharpodonty back to you when I can.

阿夫西维： 今天我们不去格子房上课吗?
Avgust: Will there be no class in the diamond caves, today?

阿夫西维： 我们可以在那里玩捉迷藏，那里有好多洞穴，就像矿场～帕索诺和尼娜也想去。
Avgust: Pasono and Nina want to have class there too. There are so many caves to play hide and seek in!

维拉： 抱歉，孩子，今天不行。也许以后，也许……也许等我们回到小镇。
Vila: I'm sorry, child, not today. Maybe later, or after we get back to Rayashki.

维拉： 我们走吧，阿夫西维同学。请和这位先生与这位女士说再见。
Vila: It's time to go, Avgust. Say goodbye to the lady and gentleman.

阿夫西维： 好吧——
Avgust: Okay.

阿夫西维： 北极熊先生，北极熊女士，再见！
Avgust: Bye-bye, Mr. Polar Bear, Mrs. Polar Bear!

基金会职员 I： 好的，再见……
Foundation Staff I: Goodbye.

孩子牵住维拉的衣角转过头去，另一只手更稳当地把向日葵抱在手里。就此，两拨人在交汇的地点分手，一大一小向着走廊的尽头迈去。
Grabbing at the corner of Vila's shirt, Avgust follows her down the corridor, gripping his sunflower tightly in his arms.

行走间，维拉轻声询问的话语如歌声一般流淌。
As they move beyond earshot of the chatting staff members, she poses a gentle question.

维拉： 阿夫西维，你为什么要脱离队伍呢?
Vila: Avgust, why are you out in the hallways all alone?

维拉： 你知道，越是在不熟悉的地方，就越应该和集体一起行动。这样才能更好地保证自己的安全。
Vila: It is best to stay with our other comrades while we're in an unfamiliar place. Do you understand? It's for your safety.

维拉： 你选择一个人来找我，应该有什么特别的理由，对吗?
Vila: Hmm. But why are you out here, little Avgust? Will you tell me?

阿夫西维： 唔……
Avgust: Uhm ...

身旁的孩子几乎从来是毫不迟疑的。因此，这短暂的踌躇让维拉在脑海中飞快设想了无数种坏情况。
It is strange to see Avgust hesitate. A dreadful series of imagined dangers pop into her mind.

但她没有出声。作为教师，她有着几乎无穷的耐心。
But she leans on her experience, waiting out his answer behind a patient, tender smile.

阿夫西维：维拉，你没有变成泡沫，也没有变成会发出滋滋声音的线……你是不是有“永恒的灵魂”？
Avgust: Vila, you didn't turn into sea foam or even a squeaking line. Does that mean you have an "eternal soul"?

维拉：……什么？
Vila: What?

阿夫西维：“永恒的灵魂”是什么呢？我猜，那是一种像铁锤同志一样的好东西，能保护有漂亮尾巴的人们，让他们不会一直睡着。
Avgust: What is an "eternal soul"? I think it is something for people with beautiful tails—something that keeps them up so they won't sleep forever.

阿夫西维：彼得森说不对，“永恒的灵魂”是一件永远不会变脏的好衣服，他的妈妈在礼拜堂见过。
Avgust: But Pyotr said it was like pretty clothes that never get dirty, "im-acu-late" that keep you safe. He said his mama tells him about a place where people get them, called a church.

阿夫西维：可是衣服不能保护人呀。叶甫根尼变成海燕的时候也穿着衣服，我这样告诉彼得森，他就像煮开的水壶一样突突地跳走了。
Avgust: But I told him, "Clothes can't protect people! Because I saw Evgeni, and he was wearing clothes when he turned into a sea swallow."

阿夫西维：问其他人，他们也不知道。命名日说维拉知道，我想，你有漂亮的尾巴，也没有变成泡沫，那一定是这样。
Avgust: Name Day says you will know the answer, but even if you don't, I think you must have one. That's why you have a pretty tail and you don't turn into sea foam.

维拉睁大了眼睛。半晌，她停下来，转过身。
Vila's eyes widen. She stops and turns to him inquisitively.

维拉：泡沫……嗯。我知道你在说什么了，是那个童话，对吗？
Vila: Turn into sea foam ... I understand now. You're thinking about that fairy tale, aren't you?

维拉：是的，它可能的确脱胎自鲁萨尔卡的传说，或者我们可以说它源于偏见。
Vila: You know that story came from the legends of the Rusalka, or perhaps I should say the stories humans told about us.

维拉：但那归根结底其实都只是，故事……
Vila: But they're only stories, nothing more.

维拉一边思忖着更好的解释，一边蹲下来，与男孩平视。她没有想到对方会问起这个话题，尽管男孩一直以来的话语几乎本就由出乎意料组成。
She stoops down, looking into Avgust's eyes, searching for a better answer to match his own search. His questions never had conventional answers.

阿夫西维：你没有变成泡沫。
Avgust: You didn't turn into sea foam.

维拉：是的，我没有。
Vila: No, I didn't.

维拉：但这并不是因为我有“永恒的灵魂”。人们指认事物，将白纸折叠成各种形状，给它们安上名头。“永恒的灵魂”也只是其中一个。
Vila: People fold paper into different shapes and give them names. That's just what they do; the "eternal soul" is very much like that.

维拉：就像这样。
Vila: And a little like a paper plane.

从记事本上撕下最后一页空白，手指利落地翻覆过后，一架流线平稳的纸飞机出现在了维拉手中。
She tears a page from her notebook and folds it swiftly into a paper plane.

阿夫西维： 海燕！
Avgust: A sea swallow!

阿夫西维： 我也会叠海燕，我也有“永恒的灵魂”吗?
Avgust: I can fold one of those, too. Does that mean I have an "eternal soul"?

维拉： 不，不是这样的，孩子。
Vila: No, that isn't so.

维拉： 这是一只纸做的海燕，但你也可以叫它“永恒的灵魂”，叫它“铁饭碗”，甚至叫它“克努特大叔的锅子”……
Vila: This paper—sea swallow, the shape doesn't really matter, nor does its name. You can call it an "eternal soul," a "sea swallow," or even "Comrade Patrik's pot."

维拉： 它有这些名字，只是因为你这样认为。
Vila: Anything you'd like to call it.

阿夫西维： 可它看起来不像一个锅子，还比不上我帽子上的洞。至少，我可以从里面观察我的朋友们。
Avgust: But it doesn't look like a pot! I don't think it would work like a pot either! So it's useless! Even the hole in my hat has its uses. At least it helps me to see my friends.

阿夫西维： 它也不能……保护你。
Avgust: And even if it is a sea swallow, it can't protect you either.

维拉： 是的。因为无论它叫什么，归根结底，其实都只是一张白纸。
Vila: You're right, little Avgust. No matter what we call it, it's only a folded piece of paper.

维拉： 从窗户里飞走之后——
Vila: Once it flies away ...

维拉： 你瞧，它就消失了。
Vila: It disappears.

阿夫西维： 我总是抓不住帕索诺叠的海燕。
Avgust: I can never catch the sea swallows that Pasono folds. They fly very, very far.

阿夫西维： 因为它飞得很远。而且，海燕飞翔的时候是自由的。
Avgust: And when they're flying, they are so free. They can't be caught by anyone, even on tip-toes.

维拉： 但你会叠青蛙、向日葵、北极熊……你有自己能做到和抓住的，阿夫西维同志。
Vila: But just because you can't catch others doesn't mean you cannot make your own. Like your frogs, sunflowers, and polar bears. These things you fold for yourself, they will be there for you, Avgust.

维拉： 总之，总有人希望找到点什么，然后管它叫“永恒的灵魂”，即使这东西并不能保护什么……能保护我们的，只有我们自己。
Vila: These paper shapes, they aren't really frogs and planes. We just call them that, like we call it "an eternal soul." But to name it, that doesn't give us any special protection. No. We have to protect ourselves.

男孩若有所思地低下头去。比他还高出半个头的向日葵在他手中晃荡，展露他小脑袋正在思索的痕迹。
Avgust lowers his head, the slowed wagging of the sunflower reflecting in its own way, a measure of his thoughts.

维拉站起身来，向男孩伸出手。等到男孩再次舒展笑容，她等待的那只小手也来到了她的掌心。
Vila holds her hand out to him. Not long after, the little boy reaches for it as a smile returns to his face.

维拉： 现在——阿夫西维同志，我需要你来告诉我：命名日先生在哪里？
Vila: Now, a mission for you, Comrade Avgust—tell me, where is Mr. Name Day?

阿夫西维： 收到！他们在布林饼同志的地盘。首先，我们要爬上一片石头梯……
Avgust: He is with the others; they're going to see Comrade Blini! We will need to climb the stone stairs first.

8#1
8#1

在岸边
On the Shore CH18601-02

来亚什基·劳动食堂
Canteen, Rayashki

削减公共开支之后的食堂人影寥落，一大一小两人在座位之间穿行。他们一次一次摸过那些桌布，确认整洁。
With little food to spare, few visit the canteen outside of mealtime. Yet, someone still must set the chairs and tablecloths.

这本不是维拉通常负责的内容，更不是小孩子肩负的责任，只是此刻更多的人们都聚集到广场上的举手之劳。
This isn't part of their regular schedules. However, with a lecture being planned in the public square, things are a little hectic.

片刻过后，一场讲座就会在那里展开。
And they are happy to help.

阿夫西维： ♪～♬～
Avgust: ♪ ... ♫ ...

维拉： “一艘摇摇欲坠的新船”……
Vila: "A leaky boat that could sink any moment" ...

喃喃自语间，维拉将最后一个靠窗座位上的桌布褶皱抹平。这似乎宣告着一个阶段的结束，因此她松出一口气，微笑起来。
Mumbling to herself, Vila tightens a tablecloth near the window. Realizing that this is the last one before they've finished, she smiles.

维拉： 好了。我们可以去广场了。
Vila: Well done, little comrade. Time for us to get to the square.

阿夫西维： 摇晃的新船～我们要坐着它出发，去广场～
Avgust: A leaky boat! We're sailing on it to the square!

阿夫西维： 北方哨歌也在！
Avgust: Together with Windsong!

阿夫西维： 但是，我们安抚好桌椅同志了吗？他们知道罐头同志很快就会到来，坐在他们身边，好长出更多罐头来……
Avgust: So, we've finished with our Comrade Tables and Chairs? Do they know Comrade Cans will join them real soon and bring many more friends here?

维拉： 呵呵～是的，小阿夫西维。
Vila: Heh heh, yes, little Avgust.

维拉：只要我们跟布林饼同志道别，然后确认这些桌椅同志们，都好好待在他们的位置上，就没有任何问题。因为——
Vila: We will need to say goodbye to Comrade Blini, make sure they're all set just right, and then we're good to go. Because ...

维拉：——因为——
Vila: ... Because ...

余下的话变得难以吐露，像因为窒息，也像被外力陡然扼住了咽喉。
She chokes on the word, as if a phantom hand wrapped around her neck, stifling her voice.

维拉：呃……
Vila: Urgh ...

不妙预感攀升至头皮的速度比手臂上鳞片的震颤更快，抬起头，维拉下意识向窗外投去一瞥。
The meaning is clear even before her scales begin shivering. Vila raises her head, eyes darting out beyond the window.

她的“同胞”找到她了。
Her "people" have found her.

维拉：咳——咳咳！
Vila: *cough*

阿夫西维：维拉?
Avgust: Vila?

维拉：阿夫西维……
Vila: Avgust ...

维拉：我需要你现在去叫上你的同学们，去找到叶甫根尼同志，和他呆在一起。
Vila: Listen, Avgust, you must go gather all your classmates and bring them to Comrade Evgeni. Stay with him.

维拉：你知道他在哪里，对吧?
Vila: You know where to find him, right?

阿夫西维：我知道！
Avgust: I do!

维拉：那就快出发吧，阿夫西维同志。这是一个……只属于你的任务。
Vila: Go on now, Comrade Avgust. It is up to you to complete this important mission.

来亚什基·港口
Port, Rayashki

在码头的卸货区，围绕着驳船安全区的水域，有一个偏离了小镇中线，因此不被察觉的盲点，维拉知道。
Nearby the docks, there is a place blocked off by discarded containers and machinery, a hidden place in the water known to few besides Vila.

在来亚什基极少出现的温暖天气里，除了游泳馆之外，这儿原本是她最常去到的地方。
A respite in Rayashki's rare warm days, a place where she could stretch out her "legs" away when the swimming pool proved too crowded, too public.

维拉：……
Vila: ...

维拉：萨莫蒂瓦。
Vila: Samodiva.

维拉：一连串旋律裹挟着怪异的音节很快被当作回应抛出，就像被奇肯恩扔上码头的水藻，掷地有声，滞重而潮湿。
Вила: A large wave rises and then splashes onto the shore, accompanied by a melodious sound, one familiar to her people.

一位不速之客。
Rayashki prides itself on welcoming everyone. Yet, this is an uninvited guest.

萨莫蒂瓦：维拉。
Samodiva: *Vila.*

萨莫蒂瓦：什么时候我们已经可以从问候开始对话了？提醒我一下。
Samodiva: *Refresh my memory: Do we always start our conversations this way?*

维拉：你不该来这里。
Vila: You shouldn't be here.

萨莫蒂瓦：而你这杂种不该试图教我做任何事。
Samodiva: *You should not presume to tell me where I can and cannot go, traitor.*

维拉：……
Vila: ...

萨莫蒂瓦：你逃走之后，从不在任何地方久留……不在我们被驱逐的起点，也不在那个肮脏的内陆港口……
Samodiva: *You've always stayed on the move, Vila. One place to the next, never tied down. Hopping from port to muddy little port, through the greatest of the scaleless cities.*

萨莫蒂瓦：我还以为你最终去了一个怎样令人流连忘返的地方，可结果……看看这里。
Samodiva: *To think this would be the place you'd stay—an old dried-out shell you were too tired to shed off.*

萨莫蒂瓦：哈，一个硕大的植物坟场。无鳞鬼围绕着尸体载歌载舞，甚至在上面建起“家园”。
Samodiva: *Here where the scaleless build their "home," scrounging under the landbed for scraps, like carrion crabs.*

萨莫蒂瓦：这倒是不错，和我们一样。
Samodiva: *How pitiful, that we might be so easily mistaken for them.*

可以说维拉对这天其实早有预见。纯血同族对清除“不洁”的偏执，就像荒野里遍生的苔藓，反复生长，除之不尽。
She'd run as far as she could, but still they found her. They were relentless. Her kin would stop at nothing to eliminate half-bloods—no stone unturned, no place too remote.

维拉：如果没有人站出来，仇恨将永远循环下去。我已经告诉过你了，萨莫蒂瓦。
Vila: I wish you could see, Samodiva. This hatred between our peoples, there's no way out this whirlpool, until we choose to stop it.

维拉：这恨也蒙蔽了你的双眼，所以你才看不见……看不见我和他们能描绘的一切。
Vila: It has blinded you. That's why you can't see what we've been trying to build. What the world could be ...

维拉：你只能看见你想要看到的。
Vila: Instead, you see what you want to see.

萨莫蒂瓦：那很重要吗？无论如何，这次我不会再给你选择了。
Samodiva: *Do you think it matters to me what you see in this crab nest? Tides take it. I'm here for you.*

萨莫蒂瓦：你只能死。
Samodiva: *You die today.*

???: ——维拉——维拉女士——
???: Vila—Ms. Vila—

???: 我的讲座马上就要开始了，我想请你帮个忙——
???: My lecture is starting soon. I was hoping you'd do me a favor.

这声音立刻将两位人鱼与水中举起的锋利水箭一起钉在了原地。
Samodiva's summoned arrows of razor-sharp water hang in the air, halted by the sudden intrusion.

???: ……哦，等等，我的资料……
???: Oops, my files ...

维拉几乎是惊恐地注意到，面前同族金色的眼睛饶有趣味地眯起了。那些由水塑型而成的箭矢也随主人视线调转方位，不再对着自己，而是朝向先前声音的来源。
Vila, halting her breath, catches her foe's eyes darting toward the sound, narrowing with enjoyment. His arrows turn in a new direction ...

北方哨歌: ——朝着半路停下，正适合作为标靶的北方哨歌。
... and point straight at the source of voice, Windsong.

北方哨歌: 该死，在哪儿呢……
Windsong: D**n it, where is it?

维拉: 不——
Vila: NO—

维拉从不知道自己的喉咙里能发出这样的声音。
Vila didn't know that she could make a sound like that.

一种细微的，但异常愤怒的声响。而后，她甚至开始使用并不娴熟、如同歌谣一般的古老语言发出警告。
It was melodious but dark and irritated; the sound of an ancient language, one she never mastered. She's warning him.

从萨莫蒂瓦身后出现的水刃并不如前者的武器锋利，它们看上去甚至相当柔软，难以成型。
More water arrows took shape, surrounding Samodiva, these ones distinctly less sharp.

维拉: 不。你不能这样做。
Vila: *Don't do this.*

尽管如此，在萨莫蒂瓦缺少鳞片保护的脖颈处，一道青色的血痕也已经留下了。
Blunt as these arrows might seem, they produce a thin red line across his neck.

萨莫蒂瓦: ……什么?
Samodiva: *What?*

维拉: 你不能夺走她的生命，因为这里所有的生命都属于我，连同灵魂一起。
Vila: *You can't take her life or the lives of anyone here. Their souls are not for you. These are my people now.*

维拉: 如果你坚持如此……就算我杀不死你，我也会让你在余下的百年里都只能靠舔舐伤口过活。
Vila: *Harm them, and you'll spend the rest of your life in regretting it, short though it may be.*

萨莫蒂瓦: 你说什么？你这该死的杂种——
Samodiva: *What? You little—*

维拉: 你该离开这里了，萨莫蒂瓦。
Vila: *It is time for you to leave, Samodiva.*

维拉: 不要让我重复第三次。
Vila: *Don't make me tell you twice.*

话音落下，维拉的呼吸也凝滞了。
She holds her breath.

以往逃亡时比这还要无助的情况数不胜数，却从没有哪一次让她如此期望自己的装腔作势能够尽快奏效。
This isn't the first time she's bluffed like this, but the stakes are higher now than they've ever been. She can't afford to give anything away.

维拉：……
Vila: ...

萨莫蒂瓦：……
Samodiva: ...

漫长的沉默对峙，又或许只是极其短暂的微秒之后，箭矢破开，应声入水。
Silence. Minutes or seconds might have passed between them, until Samodiva's arrows fall loosely into the water.

即使如此，维拉也一刻都不敢放松，因为纯血的鲁萨尔卡仍然呲着那双獠牙。
Even so, Vila does not let up. Her foe bares his fangs, hissing.

萨莫蒂瓦：……当我以为，你不会比当一个叛徒更可笑的时候，你总是能出乎我的意料。
Samodiva: *Somehow, you've found a way to become something worse than a traitor.*

萨莫蒂瓦：叛离、出逃、抗拒追杀。结果事到如今……你居然告诉我，你在追求“永恒的灵魂”。
Samodiva: *You betray us, refuse to accept trial, escape from justice. And now, are you truly seeking this "eternal soul"?*

萨莫蒂瓦：你想回家，却选了一条不可能的路。
Samodiva: *You're so homesick that you'd choose any way to get back, even if that means chasing a myth.*

萨莫蒂瓦：荒谬至极。
Samodiva: *You're insane.*

维拉：事实就是这样。你也不知道那是否存在，不是吗？
Vila: How could you know that it's a myth?

萨莫蒂瓦：但你甚至不是个纯血种。
Samodiva: *Even if it were real, it would not be a half-blood like you that would find it.*

萨莫蒂瓦：就算你把这整个地方的无鳞鬼都推进海里，管他们叫“落水者”，然后与他们签下契约——
Samodiva: *Go ahead, drown all the scaleless here, have them sign their souls away to the abyss, just see if that is enough—*

萨莫蒂瓦：你也找不到那东西。你到达不了亚特兰蒂斯。
Samodiva: *But you're never going to find it. You will never reach Atlantis.*

维拉：你知道，我总是勇于尝试。
Vila: You know, I'm always open to trying new things.

萨莫蒂瓦：……呵。
Samodiva: *Heh.*

萨莫蒂瓦：那么，你最好从那个喊着你的名字的脏东西开始。
Samodiva: *Then maybe you should start with the one calling your name.*

维拉飞快回过头去，想要阻止北方哨歌继续前进。身后，裤装女人正怀抱着仪器和资料快步走来。
Vila tries to call out to Windsong, waving her away. But the Ley Lines researcher walks clumsily towards her unheeded.

北方哨歌：——维拉女士！
Windsong: Ms. Vila!

北方哨歌：在这儿做什么呢？我翻阅了咱们以前的讲座报告，按照习惯安排了这次的内容和讲解顺序，但可能还需要你的帮助来取舍一下。
Windsong: What are you doing all the way out here? I've just been working on my lecture. It's mostly a rehashing of my previous work, but anyways I thought I could use your help.

北方哨歌：因为现在的篇幅可能有些太长了……
Windsong: It might be a little too long now.

北方哨歌：……嗯？维拉女士？
Windsong: Hmm? Ms. Vila?

她似乎全然没有注意到自己身后的情况。也许海面一片平静，丝毫没有他人来过的痕迹。
The researcher seems unaware of the battle that nearly transpired there. The sea behind them is quiet and still.

萨莫蒂瓦：……下次……我要看到成果……
Samodiva: *It'd better be a corpse next time.*

萨莫蒂瓦：否则——
Samodiva: *Or—*

即使维拉一直留意着动静，手臂的鳞片也警觉地竖起——她还是没能察觉萨莫蒂瓦离开的时机。
Though she hasn't dropped her guard, she somehow misses the moment that Samodiva leaves.

只有湿冷的话语落下，维拉来不及做出任何回应。
His voice lingers in the falling of the waves.

北方哨歌：噢，如果你有什么不满意的地方，我们可以——
Windsong: Oh, if you have other suggestions, we can ...

维拉：不……
Vila: No.

维拉：不，没有，这并不针对你，北方哨歌同志。我只是有些走神。
Vila: Um, sorry. I was preoccupied with something.

维拉：关于你的问题，我想我们可以边走边聊。来吧。
Vila: We can work out your lecture on the way back. Come on.

维拉：大家应该都已经在广场上等着了。
Vila: Everyone should be waiting at the square.

北方哨歌：哦，哦！是的，没错。
Windsong: Oh, of course, of course!

北方哨歌：是这样的，为了方便入门，我在讲稿中把理线学讲座内容分为了四个板块。
Windsong: So, in order to make it easier for listeners, I divided the lecture into four parts.

北方哨歌：概述和原理阐释都没有问题。需要您来帮忙取舍和简化的，多数都在引言部分……
Windsong: I'm not so worried about my summary, and the theory part should be clear, but the introduction ...

交谈间，两人朝着小镇的中心走去，逐渐远离了码头。
The two of them walk side-by-side to the town square,

被留在她们身后的某块海面仍然轻轻地泛着水波。
leaving the tides to wash over the shore.

8#1
8#1

厨房谈话
Kitchen Conversations CH18601-03

命名日：让我来梳理一下……
Name Day: Let me go over your requests.

命名日：您需要，呃，一块儿能让几个吃饱了饭、精力旺盛的小孩儿可以随便活动的地方。
Name Day: You need a space for your most energetic kids to play.

维拉：是的，室内或者室外。光照充足最好，多晒太阳对我们都有好处。
Vila: Yes. Indoor or outdoor is fine, but a place with some sunshine would be best. A little sunshine is good for everyone, you know.

维拉：另外还需要一些纸张，白纸、废纸，就像回收利用？孩子们可以用来画画，或者叠纸飞机。
Vila: And we'll need a lot of paper. Blank paper is ideal, but waste paper is also welcome. They can use it for drawing or to make paper planes.

命名日：是的，是的，空地和白纸。好吧，后一个我可以想想办法，至于前一个——
Name Day: Yes, yes. A sunny, open space and paper. The paper should be simple, but as for the location ...

命名日：——我想，至少这里不是您中意的地方？
Name Day: I suppose you'll say a spare office isn't good enough. So, what about here?

说话间，一行人目前已经浩浩荡荡地离开食堂，来到分部的前厅。
As they converse, Name Day moves them from the Foundation's canteen and into the front hall.

棕色头发的基金会新人身后缀着一串尾巴似的小不点儿，比起身旁的独自走着的维拉，此刻他倒是更像一名教师。
The children follow him like a waddling line of ducklings. Vila can't help but think he might almost be mistaken for a teacher.

维拉：这里？虽然光照不错，地面也很宽阔……
Vila: Here? Well, it certainly has light and space.

维拉：但这不是前厅吗？
Vila: But this is the front hall. Won't it be too busy?

命名日：所有人都会走这儿进来的前厅，是的……
Name Day: Yes. It will get busy sometimes with everyone passing through.

帕索诺：——命名日老师，再给我变一次吧，求求你啦！
Pasono: Mr. Name Day, please do it again, please!

帕索诺：就是那个把纸飞机变成海燕的神秘术，你答应过的！
Pasono: Show us the arcane skill that turns paper planes into birds! You promised!

命名日还没来得及回答，另一只小手就很快把发问的孩子推搡开了。
Another interrupts him before Name Day answers.

彼得森：别喊啦，他肯定不愿意！昨天他变出来的那个沙发，坐了一会儿就变回玩具了！
Pyotr: Stop yelling. He won't do it! That sofa he conjured from the toy yesterday only lasted a few minutes!

彼得森：一点儿也没意思，还摔得我屁股疼……由此可见，他也没什么厉害的。
Pyotr: And I fell off of it! It's a dumb power.

帕索诺：那你能把纸飞机变成小鸟吗？你连变一小会儿都做不到～
Pasono: But can you turn a paper plane into a bird? I didn't think so!

帕索诺：所以，还是得看命名日老师的！
Pasono: So, Mr. Name Day is still better than you!

各有看法，互不相让，两个男孩很快争执起来。
Their spirited debate soon turns into a rolling battle.

维拉环视四周。路过的基金会职员大都形色匆匆，无人有空给这里的小小战争更多注意。
Thankfully, the many people passing by are too busy to pay it any mind and give them a wide berth.

维拉：那是什么样的神秘术？
Vila: What is it exactly that your arcane skill does, Mr. Name Day?

命名日：是我的神秘术能力，给一些没用的垃圾起名字，让它们短暂地变得“有用”……
Name Day: Well, I can transform garbage into useful items simply by naming them.

命名日：好吧，可能还是没什么用，但至少昨天还可以拿来哄哄小孩——
Name Day: I admit, it's not a very practical skill, but kids usually enjoy it.

命名日：你们、呃，天哪！不要吵了——我可以给你们变，都可以变！
Name Day: Alright, stop yelling! I'll show you whatever you want!

阿夫西维：浣熊先生，我也想看海燕……
Avgust: Mr. Raccoon, I would like to see the sea swallow too.

尼娜：我觉得，我们应该先阻止他们吵架。
Nina: I think we should stop Pyotr and Pasono first.

阿夫西维：但他们不是在唱歌吗？
Avgust: Why, aren't they just singing?

就连最离群的孩子也加入了这场“合唱”，事态似乎很快就要脱离新人的掌控。
The boys' "duet" soon becomes a chorus as the others are pulled in. And their would-be teacher tries in vain to bring them back into harmony.

命名日：抱歉，女士，这实在是……我实在是有些应付不来……
Name Day: My apologies, Ms. Vila. I really can't handle this.

维拉：没关系，你看起来就像家里最小的孩子，可以理解。
Vila: Let me guess—you're the youngest of your family? You can always tell; you might as well be a kid yourself.

维拉：嘿，走得太远了，先生们。
Vila: Hey gentlemen, you went a bit too far.

她只是轻轻地提高了一些声调，听上去仍然温柔，甚至算不上是一个提醒。
She raises her tone as she continues, but it remains calm—a reminder, not a warning.

但对两枚固执己见的红苹果先生来说，这呼唤总是立竿见影。
A practiced tone that the fighters instantly recognize, bringing their battle to a swift end.

维拉：发表看法固然重要，但请平和些，好吗？也不可以用语言攻击他人。
Vila: My lovely little comrades, you know that you are always free to express your opinions. But we must be peaceful, no? No shouting, no fighting.

维拉：我们来这里做客，代表着整个来亚什基……所以我们要做“最有礼貌的客人”，这样，等到回去之后，所有人都可以得到一块阿廖卡。
Vila: Remember, children, we're here representing our town. We don't want people to think guests from Rayashki are rude, do we? Now, if you can all behave as good guests, perhaps Comrade Vila will find us some Alenka to share.

维拉：善良的孩子是不会故意让大家都空手而归的。
Vila: Because good children should be rewarded.

彼得森：……

Pyotr: ...

彼得森：对不起，维拉老师，还有命名日先生……

Pyotr: I'm sorry, Ms. Vila, Mr. Name Day.

帕索诺：对不起，命名日先生！我不应该这样缠着你。

Pasono: Sorry, Mr. Name Day! I shouldn't have yelled at you.

命名日：天哪。没关系，没关系！完全不用这样——

Name Day: Oh it's ok, it's fine! No need to—

维拉：好的，命名日先生接受了道歉。现在，给彼此一个拥抱。

Vila: Alright, Mr. Name Day has accepted your apologies. Now it's time to give each other a hug.

孩子们于是像两个相扑选手一样撞到一起，却只是为了拥抱。他们脸颊紧贴着脸颊，头发紧贴着头发，看上去温暖而蓬松。

The boys rush to each other, arms wide. Their frowns turn to smiles. Face to face, hair tangled, they look fluffy and warm.

片刻之后，他们分开彼此，矮一些的那个男孩转过头来，有些罕见地怯怯发问了。

And after releasing each other, Pasono turns back to Vila timidly.

帕索诺：维拉老师，大家还能吃上阿廖卡吗?

Pasono: We hugged now. So, can we have Alenka too, Ms. Vila?

像是预见了这个发问一样，维拉挂起鼓励的笑脸轻快点头。

Vila knew the question before he even spoke and answers with an encouraging smile.

维拉：别担心，孩子。无论如何，阿廖卡都还会有的。

Vila: Don't worry, child. There will always be Alenka for you, no matter what.

维拉：这里阳光不错，也没有什么人过来。

Vila: Now this is better. A little sunshine and far fewer people!

维拉：地面上平坦干净，避免了磕碰的可能，正适合孩子们玩耍。

Vila: A flat area with no obstacles, perfect for the children to run around.

维拉：纸张和画笔也准备得很妥当，感谢你的帮助，命名日先生。

Vila: Well stocked with paper and paint. A place like this should be just perfect.

命名日：您的语气像极了一位品评员。

Name Day: You almost sound like a TV salesperson.

维拉：请原谅，我不太清楚那是什么。

Vila: Sorry, but what do you mean by a salesperson?

命名日：就是电视上的商品推介……哦，您说过您不常看电视。

Name Day: I only meant, the way you described it, like someone from a commercial. I forget you don't watch much TV in Rayashki.

命名日：那就请当作我没提过吧。这里确实很不错，而且它作为公共区域，最大的优点其实是“不需要申请”。

Name Day: Never mind. As you said, it should be a perfect place, and I've seen to it that you won't need any paperwork to use it.

维拉：是的，很好。他们会自己安排这个下午的。

Vila: Wonderful. I'm sure the kids are eager to have a place to themselves.

维拉：所以现在就让我们往前走一走，把空间留给孩子们吧。我还有一些问题想要请教。

Vila: Shall we let them play then? Actually, I have some questions for you.

命名日：哦，好的。
Name Day: Go ahead.

成年人相互点头确认，迈开步子朝走廊的另一头走去，却又并未离开太远。
The adults walk to the other side of the hall, though Vila maintains a watchful eye on the kids.

在窗边站定之后，反而是基金会职员先开口了。
Name Day speaks first, catching her before she can return her eyes to him.

命名日：这话我可能问过好几遍了，您可别嫌我烦……
Name Day: In fact, I had one for you as well, though I know I've already asked many times.

命名日：维拉女士，您真的不考虑加入基金会，留在这里吗?
Name Day: Is there any way we might persuade you to join the Foundation and stay here, Ms. Vila?

命名日：您说过，自己之所以选择在小镇落脚，是因为被这地方毫无芥蒂地接纳了。来亚什基充满了希望，或许可以成为一个符号、一种新世界的预兆。
Name Day: You said that you settled down in Rayashki because it took you in unconditionally, that it was so full of hope that it became the symbol of a new world to you.

维拉：“一张所有种族、所有主义都能和谐共处的蓝图。”
Vila: "A new world where all races and ideas can coexist."

维拉：是的，我这样讲过。而每当我这样畅想时，也不会忘了提及后半句——
Vila: That is how I see Rayashki, how I will always see it. But each time I say it, I cannot help but add:

维拉：它也许会失败，看上去只留下一片废墟与遗憾。
Vila: "Well, of course it may fail and end up a ruin ..."

维拉：但我们至少来过。
Vila: "But at least we've tried."

命名日：这正是我想说的，女士！基金会与您的目标是一致的。
Name Day: Perhaps then you see what I'm thinking, Ms. Vila! We share the same goal. Rayashki, the Foundation, you and I.

命名日：我们也致力于达成和平，致力于寻找和谐共处的方法。您瞧，我们甚至整天都将“愿和平与我们同在”挂在嘴边呢。
Name Day: We also strive for peace and harmony. Look at our slogan, "May the peace be with us."

命名日：这些孩子也可以进入第一防线学校学习，他们多数都有使用神秘术的资质，尤其是阿夫西维。在之前的交流会上，他的表现可以说是相当出色。
Name Day: And should you agree, then your students could join the SPDM, the school for the Foundation. We've determined that they are all talented arcanists, especially Avgust.

命名日：哦，当然，最后一点并不是利益交换的意思……只是表达一种，呃，殷切的希望。
Name Day: Oh, but please understand, it isn't that we're expecting anything from him. It's just ... sincere admiration.

维拉：我明白，先生。你也不用每次都这样谨慎地斟酌措辞，毕竟只是一些话而已。你有你的工作，不是吗?
Vila: I understand entirely. Don't worry so much over words. You have your job to do, right?

维拉：“为了更好的明天”、“为了孩子们着想”，从这些角度来看，你说的话是正确且有意义的。
Vila: "For a brighter future," "for the children." In these cases, what you said was correct. They did mean something.

维拉：但成年人总习惯于从自己的角度，将这些与设身处地无关的考量，简单包装成“为孩子好”，然后替他们做出决定。
Vila: But adults think in their adult ways. Disguising their plans by saying it is "for the children," then they make decisions for them without even asking.

维拉：我不愿也这样做。
Vila: I choose not to be such an adult.

命名日：女士……
Name Day: Madam ...

维拉：所以上次你提起第一防线学校之后，我同每一个孩子都聊过。结论是，他们都想回到小镇。
Vila: After the first time you brought up the SPDM, I made it a point to talk to each of them and give them a clear and fair argument for it. But they all want to go home. Back to Rayashki.

维拉：我也一样。
Vila: As do I.

维拉：而且，比起吸纳我个人，与整个来亚什基达成合作，对基金会来说不是更好吗?
Vila: I question, though, why you feel you've decided to pursue recruiting us individually. Wouldn't it be more beneficial to build a long-term partnership with all of Rayashki?

命名日：……
Name Day: ...

维拉弯了弯眼睛，继续说下去。
Vila seizes on the pause with a smile, turning the questions back on him.

维拉：既然说到这里，我的问题也正好与此有关。
Vila: And on the subject of cooperation, I have another question.

眼前介于男人与男孩之间的基金会职员明显松了一口气，而后再度打起精神来。
Name Day breathes out, relaxing from his bracing stance.

命名日：您请说。
Name Day: Please go on.

维拉：我注意到现在分部内的人员流动似乎非常频繁，可以推测信息流动速度应该也一致。
Vila: I have taken notice that the turnover rate in this branch is quite high. I assume, with so many coming and going, you must be getting a steady stream of information as well.

维拉：而我刚好缺乏更多了解外界的途径，需要你们来告诉我来亚什基的现状如何。
Vila: To that end, I ask that you might share some information about Rayashki with me.

维拉：在此之外，还有一个更重要的问题……
Vila: And the most important of which ...

维拉：我们什么时候才能启程回去?
Vila: When will we be able to go home?

8#1
8#1

没有寄出的信
Letters Unsent CH18601-04

命名日：……

Name Day: ...

维拉：嗯？

Vila: Hmm?

维拉不太理解命名日突然的沉默。自己提出的问题应该不至于这样使人为难，甚至令一个热情开朗的年轻人都失去语言的能力。

The sudden silence puzzles Vila. A question as simple as this should not render a talkative young man mute.

于是她歪了歪头，试图以扩大躯体动作的幅度来唤起眼前人的注意。

She tilts her head, trying to restart the topic.

维拉：命名日先生？

Vila: Mr. Name Day?

命名日：啊，抱歉。

Name Day: Oh, my apologies.

命名日：我只是在想，要怎样说出结果才不至于使您太过失望。

Name Day: I was only thinking, how I might best put it into words ...

维拉：哎。我已经说过，你不必太纠结于措辞。

Vila: Please, like I said before, don't worry over words.

维拉：谨慎当然是好的，但在我已经明确表达了信任和需要的时候，你固执的局促比起使我失望，不如说更让我伤心。

Vila: I appreciate your concern, but I am not made of glass. I've put my trust in you, and this ... hesitance to speak, it makes me worry.

命名日：天哪，女士，我绝对不是故意——

Name Day: Oh, Ms. Vila, I didn't mean at all to ...

维拉：那就请直接告诉我吧，命名日先生。我真的很需要知道。

Vila: Then tell me, Mr. Name Day. I will be needing an answer.

维拉望着眼前的年轻人。由于身量的差距，她需要微微抬起下巴，才能更好地传达那种坚决。

This young man stands slightly taller than her, so Vila slightly raises her head, hoping to catch his eyes.

在这种眼神的注视之下，命名日退缩了。他既应付不来小孩，也应付不来太过正直的人们。

Name Day flinches. Eyes running from her glance. The two things he has little way of managing—kids and the stare of an honest person.

命名日：好吧，好吧……

Name Day: As you wish ...

命名日：既然您已经注意到了人员流动相当频繁这件事，那应该也能理解为什么我们暂时没有多余的人力，能护送你们回到来亚什基。

Name Day: It seems you're picked up on our high turnover rate, but let me be clear. It is an attrition rate; we simply don't have enough manpower to escort you back to Rayashki safely.

命名日：实际上，如果不是这群孩子都还在分部，而我是早早被指派了对接的那个人，我现在可能也已经被调拨去外勤了。

Name Day: In fact, I might well be in the field too, if I hadn't been selected to host you and the children.

维拉：……人员这样缺乏吗？是不是发生了什么事？
Vila: Attrition? What do you mean? Has something happened?

命名日：不是客人需要担心的事情。既然您已经问起来了，那我也会帮你们多留意最近有没有目的地为北边的外勤任务。
Name Day: Sorry, there's little I'm at liberty to say, but it isn't anything to worry about. Still, as you are concerned, I'll see if there are any field missions in the area.

命名日：要是运气够好，也许我的同事们可以捎上一程呢？
Name Day: If we're lucky, my colleagues may be able to bring back some news.

维拉：如果有就再好不过了。
Vila: That is a good start.

维拉：那么，来亚什基现在的情况又怎么样呢？
Vila: But then, what is going on in Rayashki, exactly?

命名日：实际上，我也没有太多的了解……不过听收音机上说，来亚什基的旅游业似乎发展得如火如荼，而且，我们的行政部门在考虑将其列入年度疗养地名录。
Name Day: I admit, I don't know any more than you do. But if the radio is anything to go by, tourism in Rayashki is still in full swing. I heard administration was even considering adding it to our list for annual retreat destinations.

命名日：至少听上去都挺不错的。
Name Day: So, it must not be so bad.

维拉：其他方面呢，矿场如何？码头还在继续修缮吗？芝诺的军队完全撤离了吗？
Vila: What about the mines? The port, is it still under construction? Has Zeno left us alone?

命名日：唉，这些更具体的东西，我就一个也不清楚了……
Name Day: Aha, well they ... didn't mention any of that on the radio.

思索的光芒在维拉蓝色的瞳孔里闪烁。
Vila's blue eyes sparkle, reflecting a sea of thoughts and questions.

维拉：如果暂时没法回去，那么，或许我可以写信给他们。
Vila: Hmm, so if we can't go back for now, is it still possible to write home?

维拉：对！怎么之前我没有想到呢。基金会与来亚什基要达成合作的话，也得问问更多人的意见……
Vila: Oh, how silly of me to not think of it! I will write home and ask their opinion about further cooperation between Rayashki and the Foundation.

维拉：我得赶紧——
Vila: Oh, I should get on this right away!

果决和雷厉风行向来是描述维拉最好的词语。此刻当然也不例外。
Vila has always been known for direct and bold action, and for very good reason.

命名日：女士……！
Name Day: Madam ...

维拉：什么？
Vila: What?

命名日：先不说能替您送信的人有没有，要是您这会儿走了，阿夫西维他们怎么办？
Name Day: Aside from any questions of whether we can deliver anything, there's no need to rush. The kids are here, and I'd rather you not leave with just me to watch them.

命名日：当然，我不是在指责您！但刚才您也瞧见了，我一个人真的搞不定这些。
Name Day: Not that I'm saying you can't go, but, I worry I won't be able to manage them alone.

维拉： 噢，天哪。是的，我总是忘记你们现在人员缺乏。
Vila: Oh, of course. I forgot that you're short-handed now.

维拉： 可就真的一点人也没有了吗？只是送信也没办法，这多少有些不合常理了。
Vila: But is there really no one at all you can spare? Not even just to deliver some mail?

命名日： 送信的人当然有。我只是想说，等您写完随时可以转交，不用这么着急。
Name Day: Of course we have mail delivery. I'm just trying to say, you don't have to be in such a hurry. We can send your letters any time.

命名日： 所以现在，让我们还是在这儿晒晒太阳吧……
Name Day: So, why not enjoy the sun for now?

维拉： ……好吧，我想你说得对。
Vila: If you insist. It is a lovely day.

维拉： 现在还有时间。我可以先想想，都要向大伙儿了解些什么。
Vila: Fine then, if we have some more time, I should be able to think of some more questions.

将孩子们都安全送回各自的临时宿舍，且与命名日告别之后，维拉带着更多空白纸张回到客房。
After sending the children back to their temporary dormitory, Vila says goodbye to Name Day and returns to her room with a stack of blank paper.

她把这些纸在桌面上逐张摊开，整个下午都充斥脑海的问题都在此刻毫无遗漏地再次浮现了。
She spreads out the papers on the desk, recalling all the questions in her mind from the afternoon.

——由思念构成的关怀落在笔尖，每一个句子都自发地以温暖充斥胸腔。
Every word she writes is marked by a spark of warmth and a pang of her ever-growing homesickness.

维拉： “致克·亚·拉扎列夫。”
Vila: "To Lazarev ..."

维拉： “亲爱的同志们……”
Vila: "Dear comrades,"

“……无论打开这封信的是谁，都请找把舒适的椅子，好好地坐下来读一读，而不是站在炉子面前随意地翻阅。”
"No matter who is reading this, before you start, please find yourself a comfortable chair. Take my words seriously, not just a quick skim. Yes, even you, Knut."

“因为我接下来要讲的，每一件都是对咱们来说顶重要的事……”
"Because what I'm about to tell you is of utmost importance to all of us."

维拉： 命名日先生，这些信要麻烦你转交——
Vila: Mr. Name Day, please give these letters to ...

“在正式开始之前，我理应为这段时间的失联而道歉。真希望当你们收到这封信的时候，孩子们与我也已经坐在了回程的列车上……”
"Now, before I get to the topic, I must first apologize for losing contact. I hope most sincerely that by the time you get this letter, we will already be on our way home."

维拉： 这些是今天的信，麻烦你一定送到……
Vila: These are today's letters! Please make sure they arrive ...

“……问题太多，我总是难以取舍先后，只好想到哪里就写到哪里了……”
"There are too many questions, and I'm not so good at prioritizing, but I've heard others say here that one must 'go with the flow' ..."

“……与基金会的合作沟通，由于一些未知的不可抗力，暂时进入了停滞状态。但这封信仍需向各位一线工作者确认更多细节，以便接下来随时可能恢复的交涉……”
"Our cooperation with the Foundation has encountered some manner of force majeure and has been paused temporarily. This letter aims at gaining more details from you, our frontline workers."

“请原谅这些繁琐问题，它们涉及各个方面。其中很多都是我应该更早更积极地关切的……”
"Forgive me if I ask too many questions, but they involve every aspect of our livelihoods and Rayashki's survival, including many I should have asked much earlier."

维拉： 你在这里！这是新的信件，辛苦了……
Vila: Here you are! These are a few more letters, thank you.

“……码头的修缮工作如何了？与周边城市的交往增进也应该已经提上日程。在这些之外，房屋的重建与维护是不是早就结束了?”
"What's the progress on the repairs for the pier and dockyard? Have we established any diplomatic relations with neighboring cities? Has the rebuilding and maintenance of the houses been finished according to schedule?"

“……请留意：新建屋顶的防水板也该备足，不多时就要入秋，供暖也应该早做准备。”
"As autumn is near, have we prepared enough waterproof materials to keep the roofs in good order, and do we have enough fuel to keep things heated in the winter?"

“不过，我们现在有了煤矿，这些都应当不成问题……”
"I would suspect, and hope, that as we ramp up our coal production, none of these will be a problem."

“……”
"..."

“……”
"..."

“……祝好，仍然盼复。你们最忠诚的朋友维拉。”
"Looking forward to your reply. Warm regards, your most loyal friend, Vila."

维拉： 呼，好了。命名日先生，今天还是要麻烦你了。
Vila: Phew. Alright. With that today's letters are done.

维拉把信纸叠好，放进信封中。做完这一切，她才注意到原本以为足够用到返程的信纸已经所剩无几。
Vila folds each one and slips them into their envelopes. As she reaches for the last one, she realizes, she has used every last page from the stack.

这超出了她的预计，所以小小的惊讶不期然出现在脸上。
She stares, half-shocked, at the mound of thick envelopes before her.

维拉： 信纸居然用得这么快……
Vila: I didn't realize I had so much to say.

命名日： 是啊。恐怕您再这样写下去，我就只能去花园里砍了那棵松树给您做纸了。
Name Day: I'm afraid I'll have to cut down the pine tree in the garden for more paper if you keep writing this way.

命名日： 旁边给北方哨歌女士的信呢？我看您也落了款，应该是写完了？
Name Day: Are those letters to Ms. Windsong finished? I see you've already signed them, so I would suspect they are, yes?

维拉： 实话实说吧，还没有。我不知道她那边的情况，也不清楚她还愿不愿意回到小镇去。
Vila: Actually, not yet. I'm not sure if she'd like to return to Rayashki.

维拉：直接提问或许有些冒犯，我正在思考应该怎样修改措辞。
Vila: And I worry it might be too forward to ask her directly. I'm still choosing my words.

命名日：她是做“理线学”研究的那个人，对吗？我听说前些日子她在总部的演讲很成功。
Name Day: Windsong is that Ley Lines researcher, right? I heard her presentation in HQ was a success.

命名日：如果是这样，那么您至少可以恭喜她，然后告知一下近况……之类的。
Name Day: If so, maybe you might start by giving your congratulations, then you might ask her how she's doing these days, or something like that.

也许是见维拉许久没有回应，命名日说话的声音也逐渐减小下去。
His suggestions provoke no reaction from Vila, as Name Day gradually softens his voice.

命名日：抱歉，我没怎么写过信，所以这也只是胡乱建议。就跟站在岸边往冰面丢石头块一样，指望有一块地方是脆弱的，好打出个洞来钓鱼。
Name Day: Sorry, I don't write so very often. Maybe my suggestion isn't helpful, maybe this is useless advice, or maybe I'm like a blind squirrel.

命名日：……总之，您听听就得了。
Name Day: Anyway, feel free to forget I said anything.

维拉：不，你说的很有道理。
Vila: No, no, actually, that was a good suggestion.

维拉：我知道该怎么写了。感谢你，命名日先生。
Vila: The blind squirrel found the nut, Mr. Name Day. That was very helpful indeed.

维拉：请再等一下。我马上写完它，你就可以一起带走了。
Vila: If you don't mind, please, I'll finish these, and you can send them all together.

命名日：好的，不用急。我就坐在这儿，玩玩小刀，雕点东西，消磨一下时间……
Name Day: Take your time. I'll be sitting here waiting, killing time. Maybe I'll do some carvings with my knife.

命名日：消磨时间……
Name Day: Killing time ...

命名日：唉。
Name Day: *sigh*

命名日：真不明白这样下去有什么意义。
Name Day: I don't know why I'm doing this.

在命名日面前，由信封和信纸堆成的小山已经来到他小腿的一半高度。
The mountain of letters in front of him has grown to a daunting size.

命名日：算了，好歹也不是每一封都寄不出去。
Name Day: At least there's one letter I can send.

命名日：哈哈……
Name Day: Haha ...

但眼前的确几乎全是寄出去也不会有任何回音的东西，它们就像这里其他的垃圾一样沉默着。
The rest are not so lucky. There is no one to receive them, not even to mark "return to sender." All those words without anyone to read them.

在这些信件面前，世界是一个克莱因瓶，任何流淌进去的东西都抵达不了终点。
Questions that will never be answered.

命名日：……
Name Day: ...

面对此种场景，年轻人只感到一阵辛辣攥住了他的喉咙。
A powerless, futile anxiety burns inside him.

最终没有任何叹息以外的声音再从那里出现，他拿起信件小山上头的一封走了出去。
Finally, he takes the letter from the top of the mountain and leaves with a tender sigh.

信封上，收件人的位置是一个被斟酌后谨慎写就的名字。
A letter to an old friend.

收件人：北方哨歌。
"To: Windsong"

8#1
8#1

沉思间
As She Ponders CH18601-05

这个人迹罕至的宽阔走廊，几乎已经成为了维拉与来亚什基孩子们在基金会的固定课室。
This sunny corridor, tucked away from the bustle of the office, now serves as a classroom where Vila holds classes for the children.

在有基金会援助的常识教育之外，美术和体育活动都在这里展开，课间娱乐也一样。
Art, physical education, and the Foundation's general education courses.

维拉： 好了，孩子们。
Vila: Alright, children.

维拉： 现在请重复一遍注意事项。站在最前面的四位，每个人说一条吧。
Vila: Please repeat the rules one by one, starting with our comrades at the front.

维拉： 彼得森同志?
Vila: Comrade Pyotr?

彼得森： 第一，不要追逐打闹！
Pyotr: First, no running, no horseplay!

帕索诺： 第二，不要翻越窗台。
Pasono: Second, don't climb out of the window.

维拉： 是“不能”翻越窗台。尤其是你，帕索诺同志。
Vila: A rule made very specially for you, Comrade Pasono.

维拉： 接下来是……尼娜。
Vila: Next, Comrade Nina.

尼娜： 第三，有任何需要和问题都可以举手报告。
Nina: Third, always raise your hand to ask questions.

维拉： 是的，没错。阿夫西维同志?
Vila: Exactly. Comrade Avgust?

阿夫西维： 不能……脱离队伍。
Avgust: Do not wander away without your comrades.

阿夫西维： 不能一个人去找维拉。
Avgust: Don't look for Vila on your own.

维拉： 是的，阿夫西维同志。擅自脱离队伍是最危险的举动，即使我们在基金会，这里通常都很安全……
Vila: That's right, Comrade Avgust. Going out all alone is dangerous, even in a safe place, like the Foundation.

维拉： 但谁也无法永远保证它。
Vila: There is no place that is perfectly safe, and no place stays safe forever.

维拉： 而且，我会在这里守着你们，不需要去其他地方找我。
Vila: Besides, I'll always be right here with you, so why would you be looking for me?

阿夫西维： 维拉不写信了吗?
Avgust: Did you stop writing, Vila?

阿夫西维： 而且，今天浣熊也没有来……
Avgust: Mr. Raccoon isn't here today.

维拉： 命名日先生有他的事情要做，我们每个人都是这样，不是吗?
Vila: Mr. Name Day has his own work to do, so do we.

维拉： 你们可以玩跳棋、折海燕、看看书、画些画儿，找到自己的乐趣。
Vila: And our work today is to play chess, fold sea swallows, read books, and explore our own interests.

维拉： 去吧，快去。
Vila: Dismissed!

得到接近就地解散的信号，多数孩子们都像初出围栏的马驹一样四散而去，只有少数的几个仍然留在原地。
Like a rocket, at her word, the kids launch upwards, bouncing against the walls, until only two remain.

抱着向日葵的孩子一点也没挪动位置，站在他旁边的女孩也依旧张着担忧的眼睛。
Avgust stands beside Nina, looking at her. The little girl wears a worried face. Vila brings herself to them.

维拉： 怎么了，尼娜?
Vila: What's wrong, Nina?

尼娜： 维拉老师……
Nina: Ms. Vila ...

尼娜： 我们什么时候才能回去，回小镇去?
Nina: When are we going back to Rayashki?

尼娜： 之前我也问了命名日先生一样的问题，他说很快了。但“很快”是多久呢?
Nina: I asked Mr. Name Day the same question, and he said "soon." But how soon is soon?

阿夫西维： “很快”就是睡一觉的意思。
Avgust: "Soon" means tomorrow.

阿夫西维： 妈妈总是说，“很快了”、“就快了”、“睡一觉起来就好了”。
Avgust: Mom always said "soon," "it won't be long," "everything will be fine when you wake up tomorrow."

阿夫西维： 所以，它们应该是一样的。
Avgust: So, I think they have the same meaning.

尼娜： 那为什么现在已经是很多个“睡一觉”之后了，我们还是没有回到小镇上?
Nina: But it's already tomorrow. It's been a lot of tomorrows, and we're still here.

尼娜： 我不明白……我也想我妈妈了。
Nina: I don't understand. And I miss mama.

维拉： 不是那样的，尼娜。“很快”的意思是，我们一定会回去。
Vila: I think "soon" means that we will go home. That is for certain. And we could be on our way there at any moment.

尼娜： 但是，是什么时候呢?
Nina: But, when will that be?

维拉： ……
Vila: ...

维拉： 抱歉，请忘了刚才的话吧，尼娜。我不应该那样说的。
Vila: I'm sorry, Nina. I shouldn't have said that.

维拉： 我们应该诚实。所以我得诚实地告诉你：我不知道。
Vila: Honesty is important, so honestly, I don't know.

维拉： 我并不知道确定的时刻。但我相信，那时间不远了。毕竟命名日先生一直在努力为我们奔走。
Vila: But I am sure that we will return home once it is safe. Mr. Name Day has been helping us with just that.

维拉： 就算这话听上去很奇怪——
Vila: Though he shouldn't have to do these for us.

阿夫西维： 浣熊不停地走来走去，真奇怪。
Avgust: Mr. Raccoon keeps going in and out.

阿夫西维： 他从前厅出去，但他带回来的东西越来越少了……
Avgust: He left through the front hall, but he brings fewer things back every time.

帕索诺： ——维拉老师！这个送给你！
Pasono: Ms. Vila!

帕索诺： 阿夫西维总说这是海燕，我还是觉得，这就是纸飞机。
Pasono: Avgust always says it's a sea swallow, but I say this is a paper plane.

帕索诺： 虽然它没有战斗机那么漂亮，但这是最后一张纸啦。
Pasono: It's not as powerful as a real fighter jet, but I made it with our last piece of paper.

帕索诺： 珍稀的东西总是更宝贵，就像肉罐头和香肠。有了这个……
Pasono: Rare things are always more valuable, like canned meat and sausages.

线条流畅的纸飞机躺在维拉的手中，她突然感觉这不仅仅是一张纸的重量。
Suddenly, the paper plane in Vila's hand becomes heavier than a real jet.

帕索诺： 您一定可以带我们回去的!
Pasono: I'm sure you will be able to take us home with this.

轻飘的“海燕”与重逾千吨的飞机在此时成为一组模糊到相似的概念。
Is it folded paper or military-grade steel? She can't tell.

除了道谢之外，维拉不知道该说些什么。
And nothing seems to fit as an answer.

维拉： ……谢谢。
Vila: Thank you, Pasono.

维拉： 这真是一架完美的飞机。
Vila: This is indeed a well-made plane.

阿夫西维：这是一只海燕，一个“永恒的灵魂”！它一定能飞得远远的，飞回小镇上去。
Avgust: This is a sea swallow, an "eternal soul"! It will fly far, far enough to reach the town.

尼娜：它能带我们回去吗?
Nina: Can it take us all back too?

尼娜：我想念小镇的大家……
Nina: I miss everyone. I miss Rayashki.

维拉：我们一定会回去的。
Vila: We will go home.

帕索诺：没错！而且这些天里，我折纸的手艺越来越好了，足够展示给所有人看。
Pasono: Yay! I've practiced my paper folding. So I can make real good stuff now!

帕索诺：本来还想做一个送给克努特大叔，但现在已经没有纸可以用了。
Pasono: I want to make one for Uncle Knut too.

帕索诺：命名日带来的那些纸都用完啦！一张不剩，干干净净。
Pasono: But we're running out of the paper Mr. Name Day brought us.

阿夫西维：维拉，帕索诺说，“永恒的灵魂”用完了。
Avgust: Vila, Pasono says we're running out of "eternal souls."

阿夫西维：我们可以给他其他的东西吗？也是“永恒的灵魂”，可以被叠成海燕……
Avgust: Could we give him other things that are like an "eternal soul"? Something he can fold into more sea swallows and other things.

维拉：好，让我来想想办法。
Vila: Okay. I'll see what I can do.

帕索诺：为什么纸也是“永恒的灵魂”？那不是童话书里的东西吗?
Pasono: Why do you call paper "eternal souls"? Souls are for people, not paper!

帕索诺：我给我妹妹念过一个鲁萨尔卡公主的故事。她为了人类的王子，把鱼尾巴和歌声换成双腿来到岸上，最后什么也没得到，回到海里，变成了泡沫。
Pasono: I once read a story about a Rusalka princess to my sister. The princess traded her fish tail and her voice for a pair of legs, but she didn't get what she wanted and turned into foam.

帕索诺：我不喜欢这个故事，那个公主就和傻子伊凡一样。
Pasono: I don't like that story. That princess is like Ivan the Fool. She doesn't make sense.

阿夫西维：维拉不是傻子伊凡。
Avgust: Vila is not Ivan the Fool.

帕索诺：我没说维拉！维拉又不是……公主。而且书上说鲁萨尔卡都没有“永恒的灵魂”，所以才会变成泡沫，我觉得不对。
Pasono: I'm not referring to Ms. Vila! She's not a princess. Besides, the book says Rusalki will eventually turn into foam because they don't have an "eternal soul."

帕索诺：维拉肯定有“永恒的灵魂”。
Pasono: That's not Ms. Vila's case. She must have one.

阿夫西维：不是这样的。维拉告诉过我……
Avgust: No, paper is the name we give souls, Vila told me ...

孩童稚嫩的争论声让维拉轻笑起来，她决定罕见地放过这次“冲突”。
Amused by their discussion, Vila decides it best not to intervene.

拍拍站在两人中间，随时准备介入的彼得森，维拉以眼神嘱咐他不必紧张。作为最大的孩子，他对肩负起这样的责任已经轻车熟路。
Pyotr, though, is anxious. As the oldest boy, he feels he must break up any fights, to keep everyone in line. Vila gently taps him on the shoulder to reassure him.

房间内，一台老旧的电报机正在报点。桌案上，打字机随着报点的节奏在纸张上留下自动的、断断续续的墨迹。
The sound of the telegraph and typewriter harmonizes, echoing in this little room.

命名日戴着耳机，确认着从欧洲分部发来的电报内容。
Wearing headphones, Name Day is listening to the telegram and transcribing it through the typewriter.

命名日：……“紧紧地握您的手”……
Name Day: "I wish to hold your hand tightly."

命名日：……这东西的内容怎么是倒着传过来的。
Name Day: Why is it in reversed order?

命名日：“您最忠诚的、也最坏的朋友……”
Name Day: "Your most loyal yet worst friend,"

命名日：“北方哨歌”。
Name Day: "Windsong."

命名日：嗯?
Name Day: Hmm?

熟悉的脚步声和不熟悉的敲门声在疑惑中接续响起。
Familiar footsteps approach, followed by a knock.

然而电报那头，更多的内容却始终挽留着命名日的注意力。
Name Day concentrates fully on the incoming telegram, having no idea of the coming intrusion.

???：命名日先生，请问你在里面吗?
???: Mr. Name Day, are you in there?

???：奇怪，我应该不会记错地方。
???: Hmm. This should be the place.

???：这里就是他的“收藏室”才对。
???: This is where he stores all his "collections."

???：而且里头有声音……打字机?
???: That sound. Is that a typewriter?

命名日：……该死!
Name Day: Shoot!

命名日：是维拉女士!
Name Day: It's Ms. Vila!!

他几乎是无声地尖叫起来，意识到自己既来不及把电报译文藏好，也挪不动电报机的位置。
He silently screams, realizing it's too late to hide either the letter or the telegraph.

命名日：不行，这东西不能——
Name Day: No, she must not see—

维拉：命名日先生？我听到你在里面的声音了。很抱歉现在来打扰，但我真的需要知道——
Vila: Mr. Name Day? I heard your voice. Sorry to bother you now, but I really need to know ...

维拉：我们什么时候能……
Vila: When can we ...

维拉：……回来亚什基?
Vila: Go back to Rayashki?

8#1
8#1

真实世界
Reality CH18601-06

所有事情都想兼顾的后果就是，命名日没来得及在维拉进门之前收起任何应该掩盖的东西。
Nothing can be hidden forever. A hard lesson for the struggling Name Day to accept as he scrambles across his desk.

打字机仍然根据电报的节奏敲下明文字节，只要维拉再走近两步，就能看清上面的一切。
The typewriter is still working, and Vila is one step away.

维拉：那是什么？命名日先生?
Vila: Mr. Name Day? What is that?

维拉：电报和打字机……是来自来亚什基的回信吗?
Vila: A telegraph and a typewriter. Could this be a telegram from Rayashki?

维拉：但我记得，小镇的收发室已经废弃很久了。
Vila: But how would they have gotten it out? We never replaced our machine.

维拉：这到底是——
Vila: What could that possibly—

命名日：不，这是、呃，这是我哥给我的信!
Name Day: No, uhm, no, this is actually from ... my brother!

命名日：虽然我不会责怪您，但您确实打扰了一个比较私密的时刻——
Name Day: Of course, I-I don't blame you, but you kind of interrupted a private moment ...

维拉眯起了眼睛，金色的光似乎在她瞳孔里隐约浮现。
Vila squints, eyes glimmering.

鲁萨尔卡拥有异于常人的身体素质，其中包含了极佳的视力。
换句话说，她甚至不用故意去读那些字。
Rusalki have extraordinary physical abilities, including sharp eyesight. Reading the print on the typed letter is as effortless as a glance.

维拉：……“您最忠诚的，也最坏的朋友”。
Vila: "Your most loyal yet worst friend,"

维拉：“北方哨歌”。
Vila: "Windsong."

维拉：……
Vila: ...

维拉：虽然，我也不会“责怪”你，但是……
Vila: I don't intend to accuse you, but I admit, I am confused.

维拉：你的哥哥叫北方哨歌?
Vila: Is your brother's name really Windsong?

命名日：……不……
Name Day: ... I ...

命名日： 不是那样的，维拉女士。我只是……
Name Day: It's not like that, Ms. Vila, I'm just ...

维拉： 我知道，我知道。这只是个玩笑，你不必紧张。
Vila: I know, I know. I'm only teasing. No need for theatrics.

维拉： 可以让我看看她写了什么吗?
Vila: Now, would you let me read it?

命名日： 您——或许您还是不要看了——
Name Day: I ... I don't suggest you to ...

命名日： 哦，对！基金会收到的消息，包括信件，都要先经过一套内部审核流程！
Name Day: Oh! Every message or letter the Foundation receives needs to be examined by us. Unfortunately, you can't read it now!

命名日： 北方哨歌女士的这份，由于我还在转码当中，还没有走过这个流程……
Name Day: This one is still being translated, so I haven't submitted it yet ...

维拉： 属于书报审查机构的时代已经过去了，先生。
Vila: The era of censorship is long gone, sir.

维拉： 为什么还要这样紧张呢?
Vila: Why so nervous?

维拉： 这只是一个朋友的回信而已，它能有怎样激进的内容呢?
Vila: It's only a letter from a friend. How dangerous could it be?

维拉： 您瞧，它还“紧紧地握您的手”。多么友好。
Vila: Look, it says, "I wish to hold your hand tightly." Terrifying, isn't it?

命名日： ……
Name Day: ...

当最后一缕报点的电波声消失在房间的灰尘之中，打字机也逐渐放缓了速度，直到敲尽最后一个字符。
Name Day falls silent in sync with the telegraph's staccato rhythm.

人们的沟通也几乎陷入同样的停滞。
The tension in the room thickens with the growing moment of silence.

命名日： 如果……
Name Day: If ...

命名日： 如果您实在要看，那您就看吧。
Name Day: If you insist, just go on.

命名日： 毕竟，这是您的信件，和您的自由……
Name Day: It is your letter and your right, after all ...

“北方哨歌”： 很高兴终于收到了您的信!
"Windsong": I am so happy to hear from you finally!

“北方哨歌”： 一开始我忐忑于拆开它，害怕得到什么更坏的消息。毕竟这些日子里，几乎只有这家伙与我们同进同出。
"Windsong": I was so worried that it might be even worse news when I opened the envelope. After all, that's all I have received these days.

“北方哨歌”： 所以，当我终于做好准备，坐下来一口气将它看完之后……
"Windsong": It took me quite some time to prepare myself and read it through.

“北方哨歌”： 我立刻就给您发了这封电报。
"Windsong": After that, I sent you this telegram immediately.

“北方哨歌”： 首先，您和您那些勇敢的小战士们都很好，这几乎是连日的坏事以来最令我感到宽慰的消息了。
"Windsong": First, I am so glad to know you and your little warriors are doing well. It really cheers me up after all this bad news.

“北方哨歌”： 但信中您表现出的个人状况，却实在令我疑惑。
"Windsong": However, I'm still confused by your decision.

“北方哨歌”： 您决定回去！可您难道不知道吗?
"Windsong": You're going back to Rayashki! But don't you know?

“北方哨歌”： 您不知道要回去的来亚什基，已经不是您所知、且为之拼命和奋斗过的地方了。
"Windsong": It won't be the town you remembered or the utopia we tried to build.

“北方哨歌”： 您不知道，因为“暴雨”，来亚什基的一切都改变了。
"Windsong": The "Storm" has changed everything.

“北方哨歌”： 我猜，或许是基金会选择了对您隐瞒真相。他们这样做一定有着自己的考量，但我仅作为一个朋友，是需要将真实情况和盘托出的。
"Windsong": It seems the Foundation has concealed the truth from you, but as your friend, I feel I'm obliged to tell you.

“北方哨歌”： 就我所知，“暴雨”这一现象导致的混乱持续了很长时间。不管是地点，还是生活在那地方的人，经过它的摧残之后，都只会被“回溯”。
"Windsong": As far as I know, the chaos caused by the "Storm" has been around for a long time. Wherever it goes, every building and each person there will be "reversed."

“北方哨歌”： 而“回溯”，只不过是凭空消失的另一种说法。
"Windsong": By "reversed," I mean they "vanished."

“北方哨歌”： 我还没有回去过小镇，但我去过其他曾经熟悉的地方。我亲眼看见……
"Windsong": I have not visited Rayashki yet, but I've been to many other places it has struck. I saw what comes from the "Storm" with my own eyes.

“北方哨歌”： 试想一下，您熟知的大多数人都消失了，欣欣向荣的小镇变成了一片荒芜?
"Windsong": Think about it. Everyone you know may have vanished, and that once-thriving town may only be a ruin now, if anything remains at all.

“北方哨歌”： 这并不是在恐吓您，只是描述一种在“暴雨”之后，最常见的可能情况……
"Windsong": I'm not exaggerating. This is a common fate for places impacted by the "Storm."

维拉： ……
Vila: ...

“暴雨”。
The "Storm."

这是一个维拉曾经听过的词。于是这时的视线也自然投向最先使她知晓的那个人。
A word she has heard from Name Day, now standing before her with guilt etched into his petrified face.

维拉： 原来这才是……
Vila: So ... this is ...

维拉： 真正的“暴雨”。
Vila: The truth of the "Storm."

维拉： 对吗？命名日先生。
Vila: Isn't it, Mr. Name Day?

命名日：……其实、其实“暴雨”并没有北方哨歌女士描述的这么严重。
Name Day: A-actually, the "Storm" doesn't need to be as serious as Ms. Windsong said in her letter ...

命名日：您瞧，您和阿夫西维他们，呆在基金会里，也没有受到什么伤害。
Name Day: S-see? You, Avgust, and other kids are safe and sound in the Foundation.

命名日：没有消失，没有“回溯”……
Name Day: Not vanished, not reversed ...

说到最后一个词，命名日的声音几乎是被他自己吞进了喉咙里。
His voice gets softer and softer, fading until the next sentence fails to emerge at all.

他驱使不了更多语言为他所用，甚至无法为这一刻“命名”。
Despite the ability to transform a thing by speaking a name, he finds no name, no word, suitable for the moment.

维拉：要我说，其实只是外面变得很不一样了，对不对?
Vila: It sounds like things have changed there—changed for the worse. Am I right?

维拉拍了拍年轻人的肩膀。由于身高的差距，她还需要轻轻踮起脚来，才好准确做到这个动作。
Vila tiptoes and gently taps Name Day on the shoulder.

命名日：……是很不一样。但，也没有信里说的那样，只剩下恐慌和混乱。
Name Day: Changed, yes, but it will likely not be as chaotic and ruined as you might imagine from Ms. Windsong's letter.

命名日：唉，我不是想说这个。就算这样，您也不考虑留在基金会吗?
Name Day: Ah, well, I suppose that isn't the point. It's only that, I think you should consider staying here, even after this letter.

阿夫西维：唔……
Avgust: Hmm ...

小男孩沉思时也会发出一阵子仿佛嘟囔的声音，这动静在此处是这样不同寻常，以至于两个成年人都因此回过头去。
Startled by the sound of miniature contemplation, they turn around and see the least likely person to be here.

维拉：阿夫西维?
Vila: AVGUST?!

命名日：……阿夫西维同学?
Name Day: Avgust?

命名日：你是什么时候进来的？而且，你拿着，呃，什么东西?
Name Day: When did you ... What are those in your hand?

命名日：啊。
Name Day: Ah.

男孩举起手中的信封，像高高举起一面旗帜。
Avgust raises the envelope in his hand as if holding up a flag.

阿夫西维：维拉，你看，这里有好多“永恒的灵魂”!
Avgust: Look, Vila, so many "eternal souls"!

阿夫西维：你是来找它们的对不对?
Avgust: You're here for them, right?

维拉：这是……?
Vila: What are these?

维拉：……

Vila: ...

没有寄出的信件安静地伫立于角落，如金币堆叠，等待着被寻宝者发现。
All her unsent letters, piling up at the corner.

小小的男孩站在它们面前，懵懂而惊讶地瞧着手中的“战利品”之一。
Avgust doesn't know what he has found. To him, it's only a trophy, a means to another flight of sea swallows.

阿夫西维：哦，上面被涂了黑色。
Avgust: Oh, these ones are wearing black dots.

阿夫西维：不过没关系，帕索诺可以用它们来折有黑色斑点的海燕。
Avgust: Everything will be alright. We can use these for dotted sea swallows.

阿夫西维：所有的这些——这些，这些，和这些！都可以利用起来！
Avgust: We can make so many new things!

阿夫西维：帕索诺和尼娜一定会很开心。
Avgust: Pasono and Nina will be so happy!

阿夫西维：现在，我宣布你们都是“永恒的灵魂”了！
Avgust: I hereby declare that you are all "eternal souls"!

命名日：阿夫西维同学……
Name Day: Avgust ...

命名日：这不是什么，“永恒的灵魂”……
Name Day: These are not "eternal souls" ...

维拉：没关系。
Vila: It will be fine.

维拉：阿夫西维同志说得一点儿也没错，命名日先生。
Vila: Avgust is right, Mr. Name Day.

维拉：如果我们觉得这是“永恒的灵魂”，那它就可以是。
Vila: They could be anything we think they are, including "eternal souls."

维拉：这没什么讲究。
Vila: They're nothing special anymore.

维拉：更何况现在它们也没有其他用处了，不是吗?
Vila: They aren't going to be of any other use.

命名日：……抱歉。
Name Day: I'm sorry.

维拉：不必道歉。我说过了，你有你的工作要做，而我……
Vila: You don't have to. As I said, you have your job to do, and I ...

维拉：即使是现在，我也有我需要做的事。
Vila: I also have mine, even in this situation.

维拉：……呼。
Vila: *breathes out*

维拉：还好你没有把它们寄出去。这样，孩子们就有新的折纸可以用了。
Vila: I suppose we're lucky you didn't send them. Now the children have some more paper.

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日光灿烂
Under the Warm Sun CH18601-07

不知怎的，未来似乎并没有站在自己的位置上。
Time seems to be frozen in the utility room.

各自的若有所思之间，沉默已如河般流淌了许久。
The sound of breathing is the only sign of its passage.

两人注视着静止的信件，悬而未决的问题始终存在。
Staring at the pile of letters between them, both Vila and Name Day realize that their problems demand answers.

维拉： 北方哨歌同志不建议我回去。命名日先生，你怎么看?
Vila: Comrade Windsong did not say whether it was a good idea to return.

命名日： 刚才我也问了您……
Name Day: As I just asked ...

命名日： 就算这样，您也要选择回去吗?
Name Day: Would you consider staying here, even after knowing what was in this letter?

维拉： 你瞧，你的问题并没有预设我会因为得知真相而放弃。
Vila: See, your question shows you don't think the truth will stop me.

维拉： 看来我们对这件事的认知都没有改变。
Vila: Looks like neither of us have changed our minds.

维拉摇头，走上去把信从打字机的架子上拿下来。
Vila shakes her head, taking the letter off the typewriter.

维拉： 你知道我还是会选择回到小镇，我也知道你希望我留在基金会。
Vila: You know I'm still going, and I know you'd prefer for us to stay here.

命名日： 好吧。那么……既然您已经知道了真相，那我们也没有理由继续回避了。
Name Day: Alright. Since you know the truth, I won't keep it from you any further.

命名日： 您打算明天就启程吗?
Name Day: Are you setting off tomorrow?

维拉： 如果可以的话，当然。仔细想来，我等这一天太久了，不是吗?
Vila: If possible, sure. We've waited for too long—Too long not to know.

维拉： 但我只是需要去亲眼看一看。
Vila: All I want is a chance to see it with my own eyes.

命名日： 好的，我们会尽量……
Name Day: I'll try my best to ...

命名日： 唉。我记得我来告诉您“暴雨”发生的那天，阿夫西维同学也因为好奇而脱离了队伍。
Name Day: *sigh* Remember I told you what happened that day when the "Storm" fell? That Avgust went out alone to take a look.

维拉： 是啊。那时我并没有清晰地了解“暴雨”的面貌，至少没有今天这样清晰。
Vila: I remember. But back then, I didn't know much about the "Storm," less even than what I know now.

维拉： 我以为他只是走失……
Vila: I thought he just got lost.

维拉： 却没有想到他可能看到了什么。
Vila: I had no idea what he might have seen.

话语间，维拉将目光投向身边的男孩。他似乎正致力于把每一张纸从信封中拆出来展平，放成完整的一叠。
Vila looks to Avgust, who is taking each letter from its envelope and piling them up.

就像千层饼。
Their different layers, one after another, begin to resemble, at least in the mind of Avgust, a layered cake.

阿夫西维：——拿破仑蛋糕！
Avgust: A Napoleon Cake!

阿夫西维：维拉，你看～
Avgust: Look, Vila!

维拉：谢谢你的蛋糕，阿夫西维同志。但是我说过什么来着?
Vila: Thank you for the cake, but did you forget what I said, Comrade Avgust?

维拉：不能一个人——
Vila: Don't go out alone.

阿夫西维：维拉来找“永恒的灵魂”，我觉得，我也可以帮忙。
Avgust: But since you're here for these "eternal souls," I think we can help.

阿夫西维：而且，我不是一个人来的呀。
Avgust: But I didn't leave my comrades!

男孩指向门外，几枚衣角被飞快地藏起来。接着，老鼠一样细小的推搡声响起。
He points at the door. They see the edge of some clothes hidden behind the door frame, accompanied by grouchy whispers.

???：你不要挤我——我都听不见啦！
???: Don't push me—I can't hear anything!

???：还听什么！阿夫西维同志出卖了我们！
???: What do you expect? Comrade Avgust just sold us out!

???：快让开！
???: Let's just go in already!

维拉：原来我们有这么多观众呢。
Vila: I had no idea we had so many listeners.

维拉：都出来吧。帕索诺、彼得森和尼娜，是吗?
Vila: Come out, all of you. Pyotr, Pasono, Nina, and anyone else you've got with you too!

维拉：正好，我也有话要同你们说。
Vila: I have something that I must tell you.

尼娜：维拉老师……
Nina: Ms. Vila ...

维拉：尼娜，我知道。我们要回去了。
Vila: I know what you want to ask, and yes, we're going home.

维拉：这就是我要同你们说的。并且顺利的话……
Vila: And if all goes well ...

维拉：是明天就会回去。
Vila: We will be going home tomorrow.

几双靴子踏上雪地，极北冬季的气息与往常几无差别。
The hard-packed snow crunches under the weight of feet, big and little, as the team led by Vila inch close to home once again.

阿夫西维： ——维拉?
Avgust: Vila?

阿夫西维： 为什么我们不从码头回家呢?
Avgust: Why didn't we come home from the pier?

阿夫西维： 那些乌龟都是从海上来的，他们把房子停在码头，然后走上岸来……
Avgust: Turtles in the sea place their houses there and then go on shore.

维拉： 其实这不是回家，阿夫西维同志。
Vila: We're not going home for good, Comrade Avgust.

维拉： 这只是一次……
Vila: This is just ...

维拉： 访问。
Vila: A visit.

维拉： 就像北方哨歌同志那样，记得吗?
Vila: Just like the ones Comrade Windsong used to make, remember?

阿夫西维： 我们是来当客人的吗？那我们要住进旅馆里？可这下面就是我们的家呀。
Avgust: Then are we guests? Does that mean we stay in the hotel tonight? But there are still houses for us, right?

阿夫西维： 而且，只能站在这里的话，我就看不见码头，也看不见雕像了。
Avgust: I can't see the pier or the statue from here.

阿夫西维： 屋顶和雪地连在一起，就像泡沫一样，把什么都遮住了。
Avgust: All the rooftops and the snow become one. The snow has covered everything.

维拉： ……我们在这里……
Vila: We're here ...

维拉： 是因为这里能把整个来亚什基收入眼底。
Vila: ... because this is the best place to see all of Rayashki.

维拉： 但……
Vila: But ...

维拉： 我也看不见码头，看不见雕像。
Vila: I see nothing. No pier. No statue.

维拉： 也许它们本就不在这里了。
Vila: They're gone.

阿夫西维： 泡沫和雪都会消失。它们是消失了。
Avgust: Both sea foam and snow all eventually vanish.

阿夫西维： 对不对?
Avgust: Vanish, is that the word?

维拉： 我不知道。
Vila: I don't know.

维拉： 有很多的问题都是我也不知道答案的。
Vila: There are a lot of questions that I can't answer.

维拉： 我的答案……也不全是正确。
Vila: Besides, I'm not always right.

在男孩兀自陷入思索的时候，女孩颤颤巍巍地抓住了维拉的手，话语也带着惶然的鼻音。
Avgust falls deep into his own mind, but Nina cautiously takes Vila's hand and asks her in a trembling voice.

尼娜：维拉老师，我们要从矿山上下去，才能回家，对吗?
Nina: Ms. Vila, wasn't the mine on our way home?

尼娜：但这里，看上去不像矿山。
Nina: But this doesn't look like the way home anymore.

尼娜：……好奇怪……
Nina: It's strange.

尼娜：我只是想回来看看妈妈，然后和帕索诺他们一起去第一防线学校。
Nina: I just want to see mama again, and then we can go back to the SPDM with Pasono.

尼娜：为什么……
Nina: Why?

尼娜：老师，这里还是来亚什基吗?
Nina: Ms. Vila, is this really Rayashki?

维拉：……
Vila: ...

维拉紧紧握住女孩儿的手，却并没有移开视线，也没有像往常一样弯下腰去，抹掉她脸上的泪水。
Vila holds her hand even tighter. This time, she doesn't bend down to wipe the tears from the little girl's face.

没有任何鼓励的话语，只有现实。
There is no soft word of comfort left in her, only hard truth.

是的，维拉记得有一条小道通往山下。即使雪天，人们也会在树上系上用旧的红布，来为上山砍柴的人示意道路。
There was a path from here down to the town. During snowy days, people would tie red tape on the trees to mark the way home.

但如今她只看到一片白茫，除了雪地上反射的日光之外，没有任何亮色。
But now she sees only white, no colors at all except the sunlight reflecting on the snow.

那条路不在这里。
The road home is gone.

维拉：……是的。
Vila: Yes.

维拉：这里是来亚什基。
Vila: This is still Rayashki.

半晌，她转过头。
A moment later, she turns around.

维拉：走吧，孩子们。
Vila: Let's go, children.

维拉：这里实在有些冷了，我们回基金会去吧。
Vila: It's getting cold out. It's time to go back.

阿夫西维：维拉?我们的“访问”结束了吗?
Avgust: Is the visit over, Vila?

维拉：是的。访问结束了。
Vila: Yes. It's over.

命名日：……女士?
Name Day: Madam ...

维拉：谢谢你，命名日先生。
Vila: Thank you very much, Mr. Name Day.

维拉：就像我们昨天说的那样……
Vila: Just as we agreed yesterday ...

维拉：我会加入基金会。
Vila: I will join the Foundation.

命名日：好好好，但其实，你们还可以在这里多呆一会儿——
Name Day: You're more than welcome! But, please, if you need, you can spend some more time here.

维拉：感谢你的好意，命名日先生。
Vila: Thank you. That's thoughtful of you.

维拉：但那已经没有必要了。
Vila: But it won't be necessary.

8#1
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教师之歌
A Song for the Teacher CH18601-08

阿夫西维：看，海燕！
Avgust: Look! A sea swallow!

男孩举起了一个皱皱巴巴的纸飞机，配合着哨声，在空中模拟飞行。
Avgust holds a half-crumpled paper plane over his head, imitating a bird in flight.

孩子们从废纸堆里找出能用的所有，又将它们都变成海燕与青蛙。
All those unsent letters, just the same as any other waste paper—the building materials for folding birds and frogs.

帕索诺：你这样折它是不对的。
Pasono: That's not right. You shouldn't fold it this way.

帕索诺：写了算术题的纸团是要拿来折斑点青蛙的，按一下就能跳的那种，你忘啦?
Pasono: Use these math papers to make dotted frogs—the ones that can jump if you flick them.

阿夫西维：可青蛙已经有很多了。
Avgust: But we already have so many frogs.

彼得森：不要争吵！
Pyotr: No fighting!

帕索诺：我没吵，我只是在说，他用错纸了……
Pasono: I wasn't! I'm just saying he used the wrong paper.

尼娜：没关系，帕索诺。我们还有很多别的纸呀。
Nina: It's ok, Pasono, we still have lots of paper.

尼娜：这些更平整的，只有十字折痕的纸，我看就很好。
Nina: These seem nice. They aren't too crumply.

尼娜：阿夫西维同志，你用这个吧。
Nina: Comrade Avgust, use this.

阿夫西维：谢谢你，尼娜同志！但我觉得，现在的海燕就很好。
Avgust: Thank you, Comrade Nina! I think this sea swallow will do just fine.

阿夫西维：它坑坑洼洼的，还有些黑黢黢……它就像冲进矿场里的海燕，身上都是战斗的勋章。
Avgust: It's a little crumpled and looks a bit dirty, but these battle scars are like medals for a hero, just like the one that saved our town.

阿夫西维：我想把它拿给维拉看。
Avgust: I want to show it to Vila.

阿夫西维：维拉——
Avgust: Vila—

不等同伴们回答，男孩就向走廊另一头正在谈话的大人们跑去。
Before his friends could answer, Avgust is in a full sprint toward the adults on the other end of the corridor.

维拉留意到他的到来，下意识张开了手表示欢迎。
Noticing his coming, Vila opens her arms, but her duty as a teacher overrides her welcome.

维拉：不要在走廊上奔跑，阿夫西维同志。
Vila: Don't run in the corridor, Comrade Avgust.

维拉：怎么了？
Vila: What's wrong?

阿夫西维：看！我的海燕！
Avgust: Look! This is my sea swallow!

阿夫西维：它是战斗过的海燕，飞了很远，很累，终于能停下来休息休息。
Avgust: It has been in many battles and flown for a long, long way. It's very tired and wants some rest.

阿夫西维：所以，我想让它停在这里。
Avgust: So, I want it to rest here with you.

皱巴巴的纸飞机停在了维拉的手心里。
The crumpled paper plane lands in Vila's palm.

维拉：哦，谢谢。谢谢你，阿夫西维同志。
Vila: Oh, thank you, Comrade Avgust.

维拉：我保证，它会在这里得到一个飞行英雄应有的待遇。
Vila: It will be treated the way a heroic sea swallow deserves, I promise.

阿夫西维：好的！
Avgust: Ok!

维拉：那我就先把它收起来，夹在本子里了……
Vila: What do you think? Perhaps it might like to rest in this notebook?

维拉：好了，这样。
Vila: Just like this. Sleep tight, little hero.

维拉：既然你来了，我正好想问，你们都做好去第一防线学校的准备了吗？
Vila: Since you're here, Comrade Avgust. I must confirm with you: are you all prepared to go to the SPDM?

阿夫西维：需要准备什么？我不明白。
Avgust: I don't understand. What do we need to prepare?

维拉：比如，你想带上什么东西，或者了解一下那里的课程，这类准备。
Vila: You must have all the things you want to take with you and study your schedule so you will know where to go.

维拉：也许尼娜会想知道那里的环境如何。
Vila: Maybe Nina would like to know what the classroom there is like.

阿夫西维：除了我的朋友们，我什么也不需要。
Avgust: I have my friends, and that's all I need.

阿夫西维：帕索诺也是这么说的。
Avgust: That's what Pasono said too.

维拉：很好……
Vila: Very well.

维拉：你们都已经是勇敢的小同志，请保护好自己，好吗?
Vila: You're all brave little comrades. You will protect yourselves and each other, won't you?

命名日：第一防线学校可以说是这个世界上最安全的地方之一了，女士。
Name Day: Ms. Vila, I assure you SPDM is one of the safest places in the world.

命名日：您完全不用担心。
Name Day: You don't have to worry.

维拉：孩子们总得学会自己保护自己。
Vila: The children will need to learn how to protect themselves sooner or later.

维拉：我甚至只是个美术老师，本来也没法永远陪着他们，不是吗?
Vila: I'm only a teacher. I can't protect them forever.

阿夫西维：维拉，你不去学校吗?
Avgust: Vila, aren't you coming with us?

阿夫西维：你是人鱼，你不去学校……那你要回到海里去了吗?
Avgust: Oh, but you're a Rusalka, so are you returning to the sea?

讶异的表情出现在了维拉脸上。
Surprise jumps across Vila's face.

维拉：什么？不，不是的。
Vila: What? No, never.

阿夫西维：如果你变成泡沫了，那我还能见到你吗?
Avgust: But will I be able to see you again if you turned into foam?

阿夫西维：一团泡沫，要怎样才能变回维拉呢……
Avgust: How could foam be turned back into Vila again?

维拉：不不不，不是那样的，孩子。我不会——变成泡沫!
Vila: No, no, Avgust, I won't—won't turn into foam!

阿夫西维：可是你说，“永恒的灵魂”只是一个名字。你没有“永恒的灵魂”，人鱼公主也没有。
Avgust: But you said the "eternal soul" is just another name. You said you don't have it, and the princess didn't have it either.

阿夫西维：帕索诺说人鱼公主变成了泡沫。
Avgust: Pasono said the Rusalka princess turned into foam when she went to the sea.

阿夫西维：所以你也会——
Avgust: So, then you will—

维拉：我不会的，孩子。
Vila: I will not, Avgust.

维拉：“永恒的灵魂”作为一个可以被任何人赋予的名词，对个人来说，是没有意义的。
Vila: The "eternal soul" is nothing. It's only a name, something that could be given to anything. It doesn't have substance; you can't touch it or catch it.

维拉：一个看不见摸不着的东西，并不会让我突然变成泡沫……即使我游回了海里。
Vila: How can something you can't even touch turn me into foam? I haven't before, and I won't now.

维拉：更何况，我不会回去。
Vila: Anyway, I won't be going back to the sea.

阿夫西维：那这究竟是什么呢？什么都是“永恒的灵魂”，但也什么都不是吗……
Avgust: Then what is it? You said it can be everything, but also nothing?

维拉弯下腰，与男孩对上视线，以便能更好地传达自己的想法。
Vila bends down, looking into Avgust's confused eyes.

维拉：起先，我也以为是那样的，它可以被轻易地指认。我所坚信的一切都可以是它，又什么都不是它。
Vila: I had the same thought at the beginning. That it could be anything I believed it to be, but maybe it didn't even exist at all.

维拉：我看见小镇弥合了不同人之间的隔阂乃至仇恨，于是，我便把这种可能认作“永恒”，将人的坚毅辨识成“灵魂”。
Vila: I saw how barriers were broken and hate driven out from that town. That's why I thought "our Rayashki" was "eternal" and the people were all good "souls."

维拉：而现在……我知道不是那样的。
Vila: But now, I understand that's not true.

阿夫西维：那什么才是?
Avgust: What is true?

维拉：是你们。
Vila: You are.

阿夫西维：我们？我就是“永恒的灵魂”吗?
Avgust: Me? Am I the "eternal soul"?

维拉：不是那样的。不是你一个人，是“你们”。你们是下一代，是族群的存续，是不会被错置的未来。
Vila: No. Not you alone, but "all of you." You are the next generation of Rayashki, the survival of our people and our dreams, a future that will not be altered or reversed.

维拉：只要有你们，那我们这些之前的人，就不会像阁楼上的酱菜罐子一样被遗忘。只要有你们——
Vila: As long as we have you, those who sacrificed themselves will never truly die, and ...

维拉：“永恒的灵魂”就存在。
Vila: The "eternal soul" will continue to exist for us and for them.

维拉：所以，这东西对于我一个人来说，是不存在的，可以随意命名的……
Vila: So, for me, the "eternal soul" is nothing and everything.

命名日：就像我的神秘术。彼得森同学说的那个沙发，记得吗？只过了一会儿，它就变回木头椅子了。
Name Day: Sounds a little like my arcane skill. Remember that sofa? It returned to a simple toy in only a few moments.

命名日：那毕竟只是个戏法，与“永恒”相去甚远。
Name Day: It's just a small trick, I'm afraid, far from "eternal."

维拉： 感谢你的补充，命名日先生。
Vila: Thanks for the example, Mr. Name Day.

命名日： 我只是看阿夫西维同学的眼神都有点儿恍惚了。
Name Day: Well, I can see that little Avgust is still very confused.

维拉： 唉，我可能的确说得太复杂了。
Vila: Perhaps I made it too complicated.

维拉： 你能听明白吗，阿夫西维同志?
Vila: Did you understand what I mean, Comrade Avgust?

男孩沉默着，似乎又陷入了自己的世界里。
Avgust doesn't reply immediately. With him, it is never easy to tell whether he's fallen back into his own little world.

又或者，他只是在尝试理解。
Or if he's piecing together something brilliant.

阿夫西维： 可是……
Avgust: But ...

阿夫西维： 可是就算我能看见你的灵魂，这也不算吗?
Avgust: But if I can see it, how can it be nothing?

维拉： 阿夫西维同志，请回神了……
Vila: What do you mean, Avgust?

维拉： 我想，应该没有人能看见另一个人的灵魂。
Vila: I don't think anyone has ever seen a soul.

阿夫西维： 可我看到你的灵魂了，是金色的!
Avgust: But I saw yours. It's golden, like the sun!

顺着男孩指向自己身后的手，维拉回过头去。
Vila turns to the direction Avgust showing her.

窗扇之外，日头已经升得很高了，阳光洒进开放走廊，把青年女性身体的廓形拉得很长很长。
The morning sun has climbed high, spilling into the open corridor and stretching the silhouette of Vila's body.

日光的澄金又勾勒这廓形，四周地面光滑如水银，仿佛下一秒，这金色的影就会向走廊的更深处流去。
Golden light surrounds her, outlining her shadow with a splash of warm yellow, a projection on a sparkling sea.

维拉： 啊……
Vila: Ah ...

金色轮廓指向的尽头，一个熟悉的身影出现了。
Then at the edge of her shadow, a familiar face.

北方哨歌： 找到了——
Windsong: Found her!

北方哨歌： 维拉女士，你真的在这里!
Windsong: You're here, Ms. Vila!

北方哨歌： 啊，还有小阿夫西维，以及一位我不认识的先生——
Windsong: Oh, little Avgust is here too, and a gentleman that I'm afraid I don't know.

北方哨歌： 你们也好啊!
Windsong: Hello to you too!

命名日： 啊，你好。你就是北方哨歌女士吧?
Name Day: Oh, hello. You must be Ms. Windsong.

北方哨歌： 是的，没错！接下来我会在远东分部这边，筹备一场演讲……
Windsong: Yes, that's right. I've come to prepare a lecture for the Far East branch.

阿夫西维： 北方哨歌！
Avgust: Windsong!

维拉： 哈哈……
Vila: Haha ...

维拉： 我也很高兴见到你，北方哨歌同志。
Vila: It is good to see you too, Ms. Windsong.

维拉： 在孩子们去学校之前，他们一定很高兴能再走进你的课堂。
Vila: I'm certain the children will be happy that they can attend one of your lectures before they go to SPDM.

维拉： 现在……就让我们走吧。去和大家站在一起。
Vila: Now, let's go join the children.

维拉： 和以前一样。
Vila: Like we used to do.

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